



CITY: Pg 2

Delhi records its warmest July night in 5 yrs; rain likely today



NATION: Pg 5

Paper leak a national epidemic: Rahul



FILM: Pg 12

'I want to play a mad character'

PM MODI ROLLS OUT PROJECTS WORTH RS 25,000 CRORE

India enters hydrogen train era

NARESH BISWANI

JIND (HARYANA): Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday flagged off India's first hydrogen-powered passenger train between Jind and Sonapat in Haryana, launching what the government described as a major step in India's clean mobility journey. The indigenously developed train places India among a select group of countries operating hydrogen-powered trains and was the centrepiece of a day during which the prime minister inaugurated and laid the foundation stone of development projects worth about Rs 25,000 crore across Haryana, Chandigarh and Punjab. The projects span railways, highways, healthcare, education and cultural infrastructure, with the hydrogen train serving as the flagship initiative of the day's announcements.

The hydrogen-powered train will cover the 89 km route between Jind and Sonapat in about two hours, stopping at 12 intermediate stations. Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw, Haryana Governor Ashim

INDIA'S FIRST HYDROGEN TRAIN



1. ROUTE & SERVICE - Jind ↔ Sonapat 89 km distance 2 hours travel time 12 intermediate stations	2. TRAIN SPECIFICATIONS 10 car trainset 2 x 1,200 kW hydrogen fuel-cell power cars (2,400 kW total) 75 km per hour maximum speed	3. HOW IT WORKS - Hydrogen stored in tanks - Fuel cell (hydrogen + oxygen → electricity) - Electricity generated on board powers the train - Essentially an electric train that generates its own electricity on board instead of drawing power from overhead lines.	4. SAFETY FEATURES - Devices detect hydrogen leaks and unusual heat - Automatic shut-off system cuts off hydrogen supply on its own - Pilot's cabin designed to keep the person safe - Special mode moves the train to safety in an emergency
5. HYDROGEN REFUELLING PROCESS - Hydrogen production or supply - Compression - High-pressure storage tanks - Dispensing equipment - Hydrogen filled into train tanks - Hydrogen is compressed, typically to high pressures, stored on site and transferred into onboard tanks through specialised dispensing systems with safety systems.			

Kumar Ghosh and Chief attended the flagging off ceremony at Jind railway station, where Modi waved as the sky blue and white train departed carrying passengers, including schoolchildren.

Designed, engineered and integrated in India using indigenous technology, the train operates on hydrogen fuel cell technology, which converts hydrogen into electricity to power the train while producing only water vapour as a by-product. The technology eliminates tailpipe emissions, reduces dependence on fossil fuels and imported fuel, generates less noise than diesel trains and does not require continuous overhead electrification because electricity is produced onboard. The use of green hydrogen also cuts reliance on electricity generated from fossil fuel based thermal power plants.

India's first hydrogen train has a 10 coach configuration, making it among the longest hydrogen powered passenger trains developed so far. It is equipped with a 3,200 HP propulsion system, which Modi described as making it "the world's most powerful hydrogen train". According to the railway ministry, the trainset is powered by a 1,200 kilowatt hydrogen fuel cell propulsion system and has

Wangchuk to continue fast till July 20 as health worsens, support grows

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Climate activist and educator Sonam Wangchuk on Friday said he would continue his indefinite hunger strike until July 20 despite doctors warning that his condition has reached a critical stage after 20 days without food. Speaking at Delhi's Jantar Mantar, Wangchuk said he was determined to remain alive until a planned march to Parliament, even as his health continued to deteriorate and appeals mounted from academics, artists, political leaders and civil society members urging him to end the fast. "I am weak from the outside but very strong inside," Wangchuk told supporters. Referring to the proposed July 20 Parliament march, he said, "I will stay alive till July 20 at any cost. If you don't come and July 20 is not successful, I will come back as a ghost," drawing cheers from the gathering.

The Cockroach Janta Party's protest over alleged examination irregularities entered its 28th day on Friday, while Wangchuk has been fasting



HIGHLIGHTS

- » Wangchuk's indefinite fast entered its 20th day at Delhi's Jantar Mantar
- » CJP's protest over alleged exam irregularities completed 28 days on Friday
- » Wangchuk said he would join the July 20 Parliament march "at any cost"
- » Doctors warned prolonged fasting could lead to organ damage

since June 28 after joining the agitation. The group is demanding Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's

Continued on P4

Anurag Kumar appointed Delhi Police Commissioner, replacing Satish Golcha



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Anurag Kumar, a former special director of the Intelligence Bureau (IB), assumed charge as the Commissioner of Police, Delhi, on Friday, succeeding Satish Golcha, who had headed the force since August 22, 2025.

A 1994-batch IPS officer of the Arunachal Pradesh-Goa-Mizoram-Union Territory (AGMUT) cadre, Kumar's appointment was approved on Thursday by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet, headed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. His appointment marks his return to the AGMUT cadre after a long deputation with the Intelligence Bureau.

The government order stated, "With the approval of the Competent Authority, Anurag Kumar, IPS (AGMUT:1994), is hereby appointed as Commissioner of Police, Delhi, with effect from the date of assumption of charge and until further orders."

Kumar's appointment supersedes three senior Delhi Police officers serving as special commissioners: Garima Bhatnagar and Rajesh Khurana, both from the 1992 batch, and Robin Hibu from the 1993 batch. As per established practice, the three officers are expected to be assigned new responsibilities.

Continued on P4

Andy Burnham set to become UK's next PM

LONDON: Andy Burnham was confirmed on Friday as the new leader of Britain's Labour Party, putting him on course to become the country's next prime minister within days. The 56-year-old MP for Makerfield, who would be Britain's seventh prime minister in ten years, called this Labour's "last chance" to deliver on promises made during the 2024 election. "We are going to give people hope back," he told supporters, thanking outgoing leader Keir Starmer for his service. Burnham, unopposed in the contest, promised to shift power away from London and criticised the privatisation drive that began under Margaret Thatcher. He plans to build a Cabinet drawing from across the party. King Charles III will formally invite him to form a government on Monday.

See P8



India rebuts ex-Japan minister's bullet train project delay claims

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Friday rejected criticism by former Japanese Justice Minister Hideki Makihara over delays in the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High Speed Rail (MAHSR) project, saying his remarks reflected "an individual opinion" that was "at considerable variance with the facts". It also said India and Japan continue to work closely on the country's first bullet train project, with construction progressing rapidly and the first section expected to become operational in 2027.

The response came after Makihara, a member of Japan's Liberal Democratic Party (LDP), blamed India for delays in the project, alleging that commitments made during negotiations were not honoured.

Addressing a press briefing in New Delhi, Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said bilateral cooperation on the landmark project remained on track.

"The India-Japan talks regarding the Mumbai-

Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail project are actually proceeding smoothly. While Japan will supply the E10 series trains, this will happen only in the early 2030s. The train is still under development," Jaiswal said.

He said both countries had agreed to begin operations with Indian high-speed trainsets until the next-generation Japanese E10 trains become available.

"At the same time, progress on the construction has been rapid. The first phase of the project itself will be operational in 2027. Thus, both sides have decided to commence operations using Indian high-speed rail coaches. The signalling system has also been ordered accordingly and meets international standards," he said.

The Ministry of Railways also rejected reports claiming that Japan had earlier offered to supply E10 trainsets. It said no such offer had been made and that the project was being implemented in line with the mutually agreed roadmap.

"There was no such offer from Japan

Continued on P4

SIT seeks more time to finalise Ram Temple theft probe, interim report likely on Monday

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: The Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the alleged theft of offerings at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya is expected to submit an interim status report to the Supreme Court on Monday while seeking more time from the Uttar Pradesh government to complete its final investigation, even as the

CLOSER LOOK

- » Trust begins 10-day Prayaschit Yagya after scandal
- » Investigation focuses on donation counting, financial irregularities, banking records and accused
- » Preliminary report flagged five major administrative and financial lapses
- » Serious gaps found in donation handling, security and monitoring

Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust has begun a 10-day purification and atonement ritual

FAITH IN MOTION



Devotees around the chariots of Lord Jagannath, Lord Balabhadra and Goddess Subhadra near the Shree Gundicha Temple during the annual Rath Yatra festival, in Puri, Odisha

P11

WIDELY REGARDED AS CRICKET'S GREATEST ALL-ROUNDER

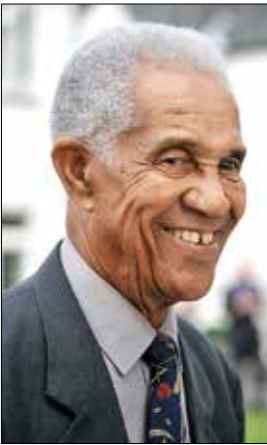
Sir Garry Sobers' final innings ends at 89

MPOST BUREAU

BRIDGETOWN (BARBADOS): Cricket lost one of its most celebrated figures on Friday as Sir Garfield Sobers, widely regarded as the greatest all-rounder the sport has produced, died at the age of 89. The former West Indies captain, whose remarkable skill with bat, ball and in the field reshaped the game over two decades, leaves behind a legacy that continues to inspire generations. His death was confirmed by his son, Daniel.

Born in Bridgetown, Barbados, in 1936, Sobers passed away just 11 days before his 90th birthday. His career remains one of the most complete in cricket history, with achievements that have stood the test of time.

Sobers represented the West Indies in 93 Test matches between March 1954 and April 1974, scoring 8,032 runs at an average of 57.78. His record includes 26 centuries and 30 half-centuries. A naturally gifted left-handed batter, he



was equally effective with the ball, capable of bowling left-arm pace, left-arm orthodox spin and wrist spin. He finished with 235 Test wickets and also appeared in one One-Day International, claiming a wicket. His brilliance extended to fielding, making him one of the finest all-round cricketers the sport has known.

Cricket West Indies (CWI) paid

TAKEAWAYS

- » Scored 8,032 Test runs at 57.78 with 26 centuries.
- » Claimed 235 Test wickets and excelled as a fielder.
- » First batter to hit six sixes in a First-Class over in 1968.
- » Captained West Indies in 39 Tests from 1965 to 1972.
- » Unbeaten 365 against Pakistan stood as Test record for 36 years.
- » Finished First-Class career with 28,314 runs and 1,043 wickets.

tribute to the legendary Barbadian on social media, writing, "A great innings has come to an end. In our hearts, now and forever, Sir Garfield Sobers."

In a longer statement, the board described him as a player whose impact reached beyond statistics.

"In the story of cricket, there are great players. There are champions. Then, there are those rare individu-

als who redefine the very meaning of greatness. Sir Garfield Sobers was the greatest cricketer the world has ever seen," CWI said.

"His mastery of batting, bowling and fielding was unparalleled, but his true significance reached far beyond the boundary ropes. Sir Garfield Sobers has completed his final innings, but his legacy will forever endure in the hearts of our region, and the story of the cricketing world."

The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) also mourned his passing, calling him "a true icon of the game and one of cricket's greatest-ever all-rounders."

"His extraordinary achievements, lasting influence on Caribbean cricket and immeasurable contribution to the global game have left an enduring legacy that will continue to inspire generations," the BCCI posted on X.

Sobers also created one of cricket's most memorable milestones in county cricket. Playing for Nottinghamshire

Continued on P4

Iran retaliates after fresh US strikes on key infrastructure

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: The United States expanded its air campaign against Iran early Friday, striking bridges, energy infrastructure and a tower at a key port as fighting over control of the Strait of Hormuz entered a new phase. Iran responded with missile attacks targeting several US-allied countries in the Middle East, including Qatar, Kuwait and Bahrain, further widening the conflict.

The latest escalation came after the collapse of an interim ceasefire agreed to last month. Since then, the US and Iran have exchanged attacks while competing for control of the strategic waterway, which carries a significant share of the world's oil and natural gas trade.

US President Donald

Trump defended the military campaign in a primetime address on Thursday, saying, "We are likewise winning big in Iran, and you will see the fruits of that labour very, very shortly."

Iranian officials said recent US strikes have killed dozens and wounded hundreds. Health Ministry spokesperson Hossein Kermanpour said that, by 6 am Friday, at least 38 people had been killed and more than 400 injured.

According to Iranian state television, overnight US strikes in Hormozgan province killed at least seven people after hitting bridges in Bandar Khamir, a coastal city on the Strait of Hormuz. The attacks appeared aimed at disrupting road and rail links connecting Bandar Abbas, Iran's main port, with the country's

Continued on P4



HOT, HUMID CONDITIONS PERSIST

Delhi records its warmest July night in 5 yrs; rain likely today

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi recorded its warmest July night in five years on Friday with the minimum temperature settling at 31 degrees Celsius, amid hot and humid conditions and elusive rainfall.

The last time the minimum temperature was higher was on July 1, 2021, as the temperature settled at 31.7 degrees Celsius.

The maximum temperature settled at 38.8 degrees Celsius, 3.6 notches above normal, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

The IMD forecast a partly cloudy sky with the possibility of thunder and lightning. During Friday evening and night, very light to light rainfall, thunderstorms accompanied by lightning, and gusty winds reaching 30-40 kmph are likely.

Station-wise data showed the maximum temperature at Lodhi Road settled at 39.0 degrees Celsius, 5.0 notches above normal, followed by 38.5



degrees Celsius at Palam (3.3 notches above normal), 38.4 degrees Celsius at Ayanagar (3.1 notches above normal), and 37.4 degrees Celsius at the Ridge station (2.6 notches above normal).

The weather office has issued a yellow alert for Saturday and Sunday, and forecast thunderstorms accompanied

by rain over the weekend.

The city recorded a minimum temperature of 31.0 degrees Celsius, 3.8 notches above normal.

At Safdarjung, the city's base weather station, the minimum temperature was 31.0 degrees Celsius, 3.8 notches above normal. Palam recorded 29.1 degrees Celsius, 2.1

notches above normal, while Lodhi Road registered 30.1 degrees Celsius, 4.1 notches above normal.

The Ridge station recorded a minimum of 25.6 degrees Celsius, 1.2 notches below normal, while Ayanagar logged 30.1 degrees Celsius, 3.6 notches above normal.

Delhi's Air Quality Index

CLOSER LOOK

» Weather office has issued a yellow alert for Sat and Sun and forecast storms accompanied by rain over the weekend

» The city recorded a minimum temp of 31.0 degrees Celsius, 3.8 notches above normal

» At Safdarjung, the city's base weather station, the minimum temp was 31.0 degrees Celsius, 3.8 notches above normal.

» Palam recorded 29.1 degrees Celsius, while Lodhi Road registered 30.1 degrees Celsius

(AQI) stood at 176 in the "moderate" category on Friday evening.

According to the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB), an AQI between 0 and 50 is considered "good", 51-100 "satisfactory", 101-200 "moderate", 201-300 "poor", 301-400 "very poor", and 401-500 "severe".

973-page chargesheet filed in IRS officer's daughter murder

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has filed a 973-page chargesheet in a city court against Rahul Meena, the former domestic help accused in the rape and killing of the 22-year-old daughter of a senior IRS officer, officials said on Friday.

Sharing details from the chargesheet, a police source said the accused's primary motive was rape and robbery, while the victim was killed during the commission of the crime.

"His motive was rape and robbery, but the victim was eventually killed. Meena strangled her to death and she died due to asphyxia," the source said, adding that the chargesheet mentions the accused's debt but does not refer to online gambling.

The source further said the chargesheet establishes four key allegations against the accused -- unauthorised entry into the house, rape, robbery and murder.

The chargesheet was filed before the court on Thursday, after the completion of the investigation by the Amar Colony police station in southeast Delhi. The matter is listed for hearing on July 18, the officials said. The victim, an IIT graduate preparing for the civil services examination, was found dead by her parents at their Kailash Hills residence in East of Kailash on the morning of April 22 after they returned home from a gym.

According to police, Meena (23), who was dismissed from his job in February over alleged financial misconduct, entered the house early that morning by using his prior knowledge of a spare key kept on the premises. Police said he raped the woman and strangled her with a mobile phone charging cable after she resisted his demand for money.



TAKEAWAYS

» The source further said the chargesheet establishes four key allegations against the accused -- unauthorised entry into the house, rape, robbery and murder

» The chargesheet was filed before the court on Thursday, after the completion of the investigation by the Amar Colony police station

Police said the crime scene was thoroughly examined by expert teams from the CFSL.

"We recreated the crime scene at the instance of the accused in the presence of CFSL experts. Sequential photography and videography documenting his alleged entry, movements inside the house and exit were conducted, while the reconstruction footage was also examined for gait-pattern analysis," the officer said.

The Behavioural Analysis Interview and Layered Voice Analysis (LVA) of the accused were also conducted by the CFSL experts during the course of the investigation.

Police said footage collected from more than 100 CCTV cameras was analysed to establish the route taken by the accused before and after the crime. The footage allegedly showed Meena entering the residential complex around 6:30 am and leaving at about 7:20 am.

He was arrested from a hotel in Dwarka later the same day. According to police, the entire robbed property was recovered at the instance of the accused. The investigators also carried out extensive field enquiries and questioned a large number of people, including neighbours, security guards, domestic workers, labourers, drivers, sweepers, auto-rickshaw drivers, taxi drivers and others present in the vicinity of the crime scene.

"Simultaneously, police teams were sent to Rajasthan, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and different parts of Delhi to verify leads, collect evidence and establish the movements of the accused before and after the crime," the officer said.

Police said the accused admitted accumulating gambling debts and told investigators the crime "just happened". The chargesheet cites 82 witnesses and extensive forensic evidence.

Bikers held for staged robbery

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Two motorcycle-borne men were arrested for allegedly staging a minor collision with a car before robbing its owner near Green Park Metro Station in south Delhi, police said on Friday.

The accused were identified as Vishal alias Piyush alias Vishnu (24), a listed bad character of Sangam Vihar police station, and Rohit Yadav (24), both residents of Sangam Vihar. According to police, the incident took place near Gate No. 2 of Green Park Metro Station, where the duo deliberately rammed their motorcycle into the complainant's car to provoke a confrontation. They allegedly assaulted the victim, snatched his One-Plus mobile phone and fled. The complainant was intercepted and assaulted again near an HP petrol pump before the accused escaped.

A case was registered at Hauz Khas police station under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. CCTV footage, technical surveillance and local intelligence led investigators to Vishal, whose movements were tracked through CCTV footage. Constable Narendar chased him for over two kilometres before apprehending him along with the motorcycle. Rohit was later arrested from Sangam Vihar, and the stolen phone was recovered.

Police said Vishal is involved in 18 previous criminal cases, while Rohit has no prior criminal record.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Friday said it is deferring the implementation of its decision to hold court on the first and third Saturdays of every month. In a notification, the high court administration said a committee constituted by Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya would look into the issue.

"It has been resolved by the hon'ble full court in its meeting held on 09.07.2026 that the earlier decision of the hon'ble full court dated 22.12.2025



Committee to review Delhi HC Saturday sittings

issued vide notification.. dated 15.01.2026 declaring the first and third Saturdays of every month as court sitting days for this court be deferred, and a committee constituted by hon'ble chief justice shall look into all relevant aspects in this regard," the notification said.

Earlier, on January 15, the high court administration notified that following a decision taken by the full court on December 22, 2025, it would hold court on the first and third Saturdays of every month.

Until then, the high court had five working days weekly,

barring Saturday and Sunday.

The move was opposed by the Delhi High Court Bar Association, which subsequently called upon lawyers to abstain from work on the two newly declared court-sitting days. The DHCBA had claimed working Saturdays entailed "serious practical difficulties".

It said the arrangement caused significant disruption to the professional schedules of lawyers, including appearances before various tribunals, arbitrations, mediation and courts outside Delhi.

No court on first, third Saturdays: HC

Girl dies after 4th floor fall, neighbour caught

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: A 15-year-old girl died after allegedly falling from the fourth floor of a building in Kaushambi on Wednesday night. Police on Friday said they had arrested the accused, who had allegedly been stalking her for nearly three months.

According to the mother's complaint, the teenager was returning home after buying milk at around 10 pm when the neighbour allegedly accosted her and dragged her into his room in a nearby building. Minutes later, she was found lying face down in the alley after falling from the fourth floor. Neighbours alerted the police, while the accused fled the scene but was arrested on Thursday evening. Police said no eyewitnesses have been identified so far and that they are investigating whether the girl

was sexually assaulted.

The victim had started working as a domestic helper in nearby housing societies after her father's death three months ago, her mother told the police. She alleged that the accused, who lived about 500 metres away, knew the girl's daily routine, had been following and harassing her, and had repeatedly pressured her to marry him.

She said the girl resisted his advances; a week before the incident the accused allegedly tried to molest her, after which the girl was fearful to step out.

Fearing escalation, the mother said she had not earlier approached police. After the fall, the girl was taken to a private hospital and then referred to GTB Hospital when her condition worsened; she died during treatment on Thursday.

2020 riots: HC issues notice to police on Sharjeel Imam's bail appeal in UAPA case

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Friday sought the Delhi Police's stand on student activist Sharjeel Imam's plea seeking bail in a case under the anti-terror UAPA law concerning the "larger conspiracy" behind the February 2020 riots here.

A bench of Justices Pratibha M Singh and Vikas Mahajan issued notice on Imam's appeal challenging the trial court's July 4 decision to dismiss his second regular bail application. The bench granted the Delhi Police two weeks to file a reply to the appeal and listed the matter for hearing on August 27.

Imam's counsel, Advocate Talib Mustafa, argued on Friday that the trial court failed to consider the "subsequent developments" after the Supreme Court refused to



release him on bail in January and that even after more than six months, the trial court proceedings have remained stagnant as charges have yet to be framed. Additional Solicitor General S V Raju, appearing for the Delhi Police, said the Supreme Court considered the aspect of trial delay when it declined relief to the accused.

"We will file a reply," he submitted while informing that the arguments of charges

were held on more than 200 days, given the number of accused persons in the case.

Imam was arrested on August 25, 2020, and booked under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) for being one of the "masterminds" of the February 2020 riots in northeast Delhi.

The violence erupted during protests against the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019, and the National Register of Citizens.

The trial court rejected Imam's bail application, saying it had "no option but to follow" the Supreme Court's January 5 order and, therefore, could neither entertain the plea nor grant him the relief. The trial court stated that the bail plea was not even maintainable before it.

In his appeal in the high

court, Imam said the trial court erred in declining to independently examine his plea for regular bail. The plea said even after six years, the proceedings before the trial court had not moved beyond the stage of arguments on the charge. On January 5, the Supreme Court refused bail to Umar Khalid and Imam in the larger conspiracy case, while granting relief to co-accused Gulfisha Fatima, Meeran Haider, Shifa Ur Rehman, Mohammad Saleem Khan and Shadab Ahmad.

A bench of Justices Arvind Kumar and N V Anjaria then observed that there was a prima facie case against Khalid and Imam under the UAPA and held that all accused could not be treated equally in view of the "hierarchy of participation". AGENCIES

PG, PHD SEE STRONG RESPONSE

Over 14K register for AUD UG admissions against 1,194 seats

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Dr B R Ambedkar University Delhi (AUD) has received more than 14,700 registrations for its undergraduate programmes for the 2026-27 academic session against 1,194 available seats, with the admission process currently underway, the university said on Friday.

According to the university, admissions to its 23 undergraduate programmes began on July 1 and will continue till July 20, after which admission lists will be published. A total of 14,758 registrations have been received so far for the undergraduate courses.

The university also reported a strong response to its postgraduate, doctoral and Integrated Teacher Education Programme (ITEP), attributing



For PhD programmes, AUD has received 2,455 registrations against 188 seats so far

the trend to growing student interest in its interdisciplinary and research-oriented academic environment.

Admissions to 28 two-year master's programmes and seven one-year master's programmes commenced on May 21 through the CUET-PG admission portal. The registration process concluded on June 26 after being extended twice to facilitate greater participation.

The university said it received 12,445 registrations

for postgraduate admissions against 1,613 seats across its one-year and two-year master's programmes. Further rounds of seat allocation are currently underway. For its PhD programmes, AUD has received 2,455 registrations against 188 seats so far. Applications for admissions to 21 doctoral programmes opened on June 5 and will remain open till July 31.

The university is also conducting admissions for its four-year Integrated Teacher

Education Programme (ITEP) at the Lodhi Road campus. Introduced in line with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, the programme has received 872 registrations for its two offerings, B.A. B.Ed. (Preparatory Stage) and B.A. B.Ed. (Secondary Stage), against a combined intake of 100 seats.

The university said the programme integrates disciplinary knowledge with professional teacher education through a multidisciplinary and practice-oriented curriculum aimed at preparing future educators.

AUD said it continues to expand its academic offerings across the humanities, social sciences, management and emerging disciplines, with an emphasis on academic rigour, experiential learning, research and field engagement.

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The growing involvement of children and adolescents in violent crime has emerged as a major concern, with experts warning that the issue extends far beyond policing and reflects deeper problems within families and society.

The concern has intensified following the murder of 19-year-old Paras in Delhi, in which three juveniles have been named as accused. While the investigation is underway and police are probing multiple angles, including an alleged dispute over Rs 150, the case has once again drawn attention to changing behavioural patterns among children and teenagers.

Official figures suggest the trend is worsening. Delhi Police registered 1,404 cases involving juveniles between January 1 and June 15 this year, nearly 30 per cent higher than the 1,080 cases recorded during the corresponding period in 2025. National Crime Records Bureau data also showed Delhi



Surge exposes gaps in family support and mental health

recorded 2,306 cases involving juveniles in conflict with the law in 2024.

The rise is also straining correctional facilities. Delhi's five primary observation and special homes for boys housed 421 juveniles against a sanctioned capacity of 285. Across all eight homes for children in conflict with the law, occupancy has frequently exceeded 500 despite a combined capacity of 400.

Mental health professionals say the figures reflect emotional distress, fractured family relationships and the absence of timely intervention. Psycholo-

gist and Marisa Inspired Transformation Therapist Rohini Singh said violent behaviour in children is rarely spontaneous but develops over time under the influence of family conflict, emotional neglect, unhealthy peer groups and prolonged exposure to violent digital content. "Children are not born violent. Their behaviour is shaped by the environment around them," she said, adding that early counselling and open communication can prevent many tragedies.

Experts also point to excessive screen time, declining parent-child interaction and the inability to cope with rejection or failure as contributing factors. They urge parents to take persistent anger, aggression, social withdrawal and sudden behavioural changes seriously rather than dismissing them as adolescence.

As juvenile crime rises, experts argue that stronger family engagement, emotional support and timely psychological intervention are as essential as law enforcement in preventing violence.

Police busts interstate fake currency racket; three arrested

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have busted an interstate counterfeit currency racket allegedly operating between Maharashtra and the national capital, arresting three people, including the alleged kingpin, officials said on Friday.

The racket came to light after a shopkeeper in Bhalswa Dairy detected fake currency while accepting payment from a customer on the night of June 29. Suspecting the notes due to their appearance and texture, he alerted a patrolling beat officer, who confirmed they were counterfeit. The suspect was detained and identified as Natraj Mohan Kanchan (62), from whom police recovered 96 fake Rs 100 notes.

During interrogation, Kanchan allegedly disclosed that he was staying at a hotel in Paharganj.

A raid on his room led to the recovery of another 180 counterfeit Rs 100 notes and 13 fake Rs 500 notes. Further investigation led to the arrest of Delhi resident Subhash Chandra, from whom 10 counterfeit Rs 100 notes were seized.

Police later raided Kanchan's residence in Navi Mumbai, where they unearthed an illegal currency printing unit and recovered a laptop, printer, lamination machine, watermark paper and other equipment used to manufacture fake notes. Vinod Munnial Jaiswar (38), allegedly the syndicate's technical mastermind, was arrested from Navi Mumbai Railway Station on July 13.

In total, police recovered 299 counterfeit currency notes. Further investigation is underway.

TOTAL CROSSES 415 CENTRES

Delhi gets 45 more care hubs

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi's push to strengthen neighbourhood healthcare received a major boost on Friday as Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated 45 new Ayushman Jan Arogya Mandirs across the Capital, taking the total number of such centres to over 415. The expansion is part of the government's plan to establish more than 1,100 primary healthcare centres, bringing medical services closer to residents and reducing the burden on hospitals.

Launching the new facilities from Shakurpur, Gupta described the initiative as a significant step towards making quality healthcare accessible to every citizen. "This is not merely about opening new health centres but a significant step towards ensuring that every resident of the capital has access to quality, affordable and dignified healthcare. Our objective is to ensure that no citizen has to travel long distances for basic medical care and that better treatment is available on time," she said.



The Chief Minister said the newly inaugurated centres will provide a range of free primary healthcare services, including general OPD consultations, maternal and child healthcare, routine immunisation, screening for non-communicable diseases, essential medicines, health counselling and nearly 80 diagnostic tests. She added that the government was focusing on disease prevention and early detection alongside treatment.

"With these new centres, more than 415 Ayushman Jan Arogya Mandirs are now serving people across Delhi. We are confident of achieving our target of establishing more than 1,100 such centres very soon," Gupta said, while urging residents to undergo regular health check-ups and adopt healthier lifestyles through exercise and yoga.

Following the healthcare programme, the Chief Minister inaugurated development projects worth approximately Rs. 14.25 crore in the Tri Nagar Assembly constituency. The projects include the reconstruction of five roads and a drain in Netaji Subhash Place, beautification of Samrat Enclave Market, development works at Gurjar Chaupal, Saini Chaupal and the Shakurpur cremation ground, besides the inauguration of eight PWD roads constructed at a cost of around Rs. 6.25 crore.

Gupta said the government was simultaneously strengthening healthcare, roads and civic infrastructure across Delhi. "For the first time, development work is being carried out on a large scale across every Assembly constituency, covering roads, drains, colonies and slum clusters. The people have elected

“Our objective is to ensure that no citizen has to travel long distances for basic medical care and that better treatment is available on time — CM GUPTA

a government that places the highest priority on public service and development," she said.

Meanwhile, Social Welfare Minister and Bawana MLA Ravinder Indraj Singh inaugurated another Ayushman Arogya Mandir at Punjab Khore.

Addressing residents, Singh said, "Ayushman Arogya Mandirs are not merely healthcare facilities but an important initiative towards building a healthier and stronger society." He added that the centres would provide doctor consultations, medicines, diagnostic tests, immunisation, maternal and child healthcare and routine check-ups under one roof, ensuring timely treatment while reducing pressure on major hospitals.

He further said, "Under the guidance of Hon'ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Delhi Government is continuously working to strengthen the healthcare system across the Capital. Our objective is to make primary healthcare services more accessible, effective and robust for every citizen."

Delhi's Atal Canteen model draws interest from states



Endgame for Dera Mandi waterlogging

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: After repeated monsoon flooding turned Dera Mandi Road into a waterlogged stretch once again, the Delhi government on Friday announced a permanent drainage project aimed at ending the chronic problem that has plagued the area for years.

Following an on-site inspection by PWD and Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh, the government said it will construct a new drainage network to improve stormwater flow and prevent rainwater from accumulating during heavy showers.

The minister inspected the affected stretch near Mandi Village in Chhatarpur along with senior officials after heavy rainfall led to severe waterlogging. While the road falls under the jurisdiction of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), officials said the Delhi government is coordinating with all concerned agencies to ensure both immediate relief and a long-term solution.

As an interim measure, PTO pumps have been deployed and are operating continuously to drain out the accumulated water.

Officials informed the minister that the location is a natural low-lying area where rainwater has historically collected. Earlier, excess water flowed through a natural drainage channel towards Haryana, but that outlet is no longer functional due to urban development, causing rainwater to remain trapped during intense rainfall.

To address the issue permanently, the Public Works Department (PWD) will construct a precast reinforced concrete (RCC) drain from Dera Mandi Road to Dera Bhati Road, which will connect to Bandh Road. From there, the collected stormwater will be pumped into the SSN Marg drain within Delhi.

Explaining the reason behind the recurring flooding, Singh said, "Mandi Gaon and Dera Gaon lie along the Delhi-Haryana border. Years ago, before large-scale urban development and before Gurugram expanded the way it has today, rainwater used to flow naturally through existing drainage channels. Today, with extensive concrete construction, rapid urbanisation and a significant increase in population, those natural pathways have disappeared. As a result, rainwater and even sewer water accumulate here during heavy rainfall."

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The minister inspected the affected stretch near Mandi Village in Chhatarpur along with senior officials after heavy rainfall led to severe waterlogging
- » While the road falls under the jurisdiction of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi, officials said the Delhi govt is coordinating with all concerned agencies to ensure both immediate relief and a long-term solution

omment and before Gurugram expanded the way it has today, rainwater used to flow naturally through existing drainage channels. Today, with extensive concrete construction, rapid urbanisation and a significant increase in population, those natural pathways have disappeared. As a result, rainwater and even sewer water accumulate here during heavy rainfall."

He said the government was focusing on long-term engineering solutions rather than temporary responses. "Our objective is not merely to remove water after every spell of rain but to create infrastructure that prevents waterlogging in the first place. Every vulnerable location is being assessed, and long-term solutions are being implemented on priority," the minister said.

Singh directed officials to prepare the project proposal on priority and ensure coordination among all departments so construction can begin at the earliest. He reiterated that ensuring safe and hassle-free movement for residents during the monsoon remains a key priority for the Delhi government.

Residents who met the minister during the inspection welcomed the proposed drainage project, expressing hope that it would finally provide a lasting solution to the area's longstanding waterlogging problem.

Govt approves Rs 33.31 cr as crop damage

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has approved more than Rs 33.31 crore in ex-gratia assistance for farmers whose crops were completely destroyed by heavy rainfall and waterlogging during August and September 2025, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced on Friday. The relief will be provided at the rate of Rs 75,000 per hectare and will benefit farmers across 4,442.41 hectares of affected agricultural land in different districts of the national capital. The amount will be transferred directly into the bank accounts of eligible farmers through the Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) system from next month.

The Chief Minister has directed the Revenue Department and district magistrates to begin the disbursement process without delay to ensure timely financial assistance. She said the government stands with farmers during times of crisis and that the compensation aims to help them recover from losses caused by extreme weather. According to the government, the affected areas were assessed as having suffered 100 per cent crop loss. Among the major allocations, Rs 8.70 crore has been sanctioned for 1,160.18 hectares in Mundka, Rs 4.49 crore for 598.58 hectares in Bawana, Rs 9.98 crore for 1,331.83 hectares in Najafgarh, and Rs 4.69 crore for 625.93 hectares in Kapashera. Other affected areas, including Alipur, Burari, Punjabi Bagh, Vikaspuri, Rohini and Matiala, have also been allotted compensation based on the extent of crop damage.

The government said only registered or recorded landowners whose crops were damaged due to the August–September 2025 rainfall will be eligible for the relief. Corporate-owned land, cultivation on Gram Sabha land and farmhouses developed as plotted properties with permanent boundary walls have been excluded from the scheme.

MP05T

Making schools safer

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has initiated the demolition of unsafe school buildings after identifying 108 government school structures as dangerous during a citywide review of ageing infrastructure. Seven buildings have already received the necessary approvals for demolition, while proposals for 54 more are under process following structural inspections.

The issue was recently reviewed by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who directed the Education Department and the Public Works Department (PWD) to expedite structural audits, remove hazardous buildings and fast-track reconstruction to ensure student safety. She also visited several schools to assess the situation on the ground.

Officials said the seven schools cleared for demolition include CM SHRI School at Chilla Village, GGSS Jasola Village, Sarvodaya Kanya Vidyalaya Karala, Government Boys Senior Secondary School Baprola, SKV Matiala, GGSS Neb Sarai and GGSS Shivaji Park.

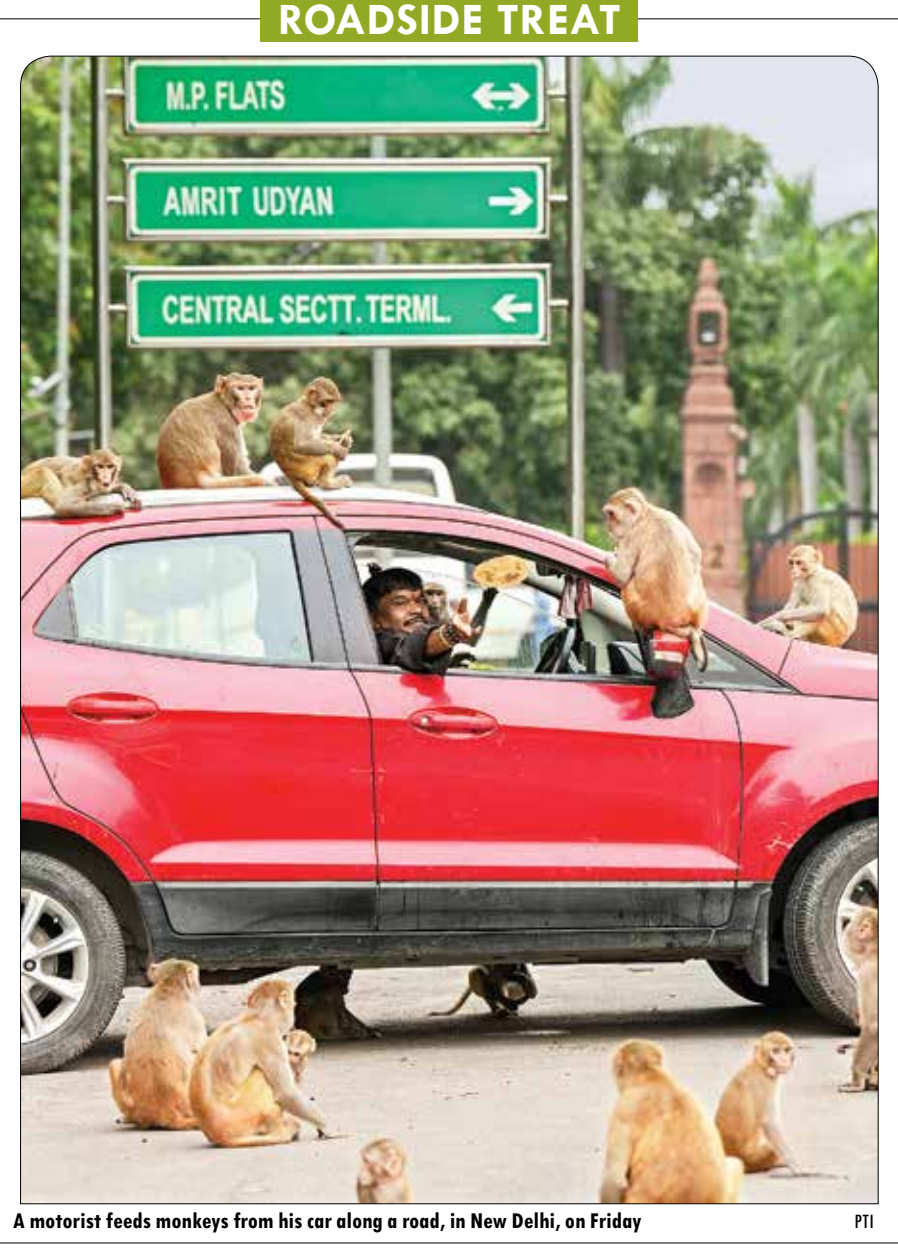
Authorities clarified that demolition will only take place after detailed structural audits and technical clearances. The PWD will determine whether a building requires complete demolition, partial rebuilding, retrofitting or repairs based on engineering assessments.

To avoid disruption to academic activities, the demolition and reconstruction exercise will be carried out in phases

To avoid disruption to academic activities, the demolition and reconstruction exercise will be carried out in phases. Students from affected campuses may be shifted temporarily to nearby schools, while work may also be undertaken block-wise or outside school hours.

The Directorate of Education has also launched a digital profiling exercise for all school buildings in Delhi. The initiative will assess structural stability along with electrical systems, plumbing, sanitation, drinking water and fire safety using drone surveys, GPS mapping and 360-degree imaging.

The government plans to replace unsafe structures with permanent, earthquake-resistant G+4 school buildings and construct additional campuses on 27 vacant government plots. Officials said the upgraded infrastructure is expected to improve classroom capacity, reduce overcrowding and provide a safer learning environment across Delhi's government schools.



A motorist feeds monkeys from his car along a road, in New Delhi, on Friday

PTI

Delhi gives ‘Sheesh Mahal’ new role

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government may rope in a private hospitality company to operate and maintain bungalow No 6 on Flagstaff Road — the former official residence of ex-chief minister Arvind Kejriwal — which is to be turned into a guest house for commercial use.

Officials said on Thursday that a portion of the camp office within the premises of the bungalow will also be completed for further utilisation.

The Public Works Department (PWD) is exploring ways to figure out the operation and maintenance of the bungalow, which is currently lying vacant and unutilised, PWD minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said.

"We may approach a reputed hospitality chain to run the



guest house and generate revenue for the government," Singh added.

Like other state guest houses, the bungalow will be used to house travelling ministers and officials for a fee.

He added that the remaining portion of the camp office may be used for official events.

A portion of the building inside will be developed to host seminars, dinners and meetings, for which "we currently have to rent out a space in private hotels," Singh added.

The final approval to this proposal is yet to be given by higher authorities, the minister said.

At present, around 10 staff members are deployed to maintain the bungalow, including daily sweeping, cleaning and operating electrical appliances such as refrigerators and air conditioners.

In the past few months, the Delhi government has floated several options for repurposing the ex-CM's residence at Flagstaff Road, which came under intense scrutiny for its alleged lavish renovation under Kejriwal's tenure.

Man kills wife

FARIDABAD: A 60-year-old man allegedly slit his wife's throat with a sharp-edged weapon after a dispute at their home in Faridabad's Shyam Colony, police said on Friday.

The victim, identified as 52-year-old Kiran, was rushed to a nearby hospital by family members but was declared dead by doctors. Following a complaint by the couple's eldest son, Karan, an FIR was registered at Palla police station. Police said Kiran lived with her husband, Arun Singh, and their three children in Shyam Colony. All three children are married. According to Karan's complaint, the family was at home on Thursday night, with each member in their respective rooms, when an argument broke out between his parents. The dispute escalated into a physical altercation. MP05T

Standing Committee polls on Jul 27

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) will hold elections for the chairman and deputy chairman of its Standing Committee on July 27.

The election has been necessitated by vacancies arising after the retirement of members of the Standing Committee, with the process to fill the vacant positions completed on July 15, according to a notice issued on Thursday.

Currently, councillor Satya Sharma (BJP) who represents Ward 226 (Gautam Puri) is the Chairperson of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) Standing Committee.

Sharma assumed the MCD Standing Committee chair-

person position following an election in June 2025, solidifying the BJP's control over the civic body's primary decision-making arm. Before her current executive role, she served as the Presiding Officer during the highly turbulent mayoral elections in early 2023.

The Standing Committee, an 18-member body, is the apex financial decision-making body of the MCD that approves major financial decisions over Rs 5 crore, contracts, policy matters and civic projects.

Currently, the committee has all 18 members, consisting of 12 BJP and six AAP councillors.

Until Wednesday, the committee was functioning with only 12 members since March, after elections to six vacant

seats remained pending, which were filled on the same day.

The upcoming election will be held at 2 pm at the MCD's Civic Centre, in accordance with the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act, 1957, and the relevant election rules.

Under Section 47(1) of the Act, the Standing Committee is required to elect one of its members as chairman and another as deputy chairman at its first meeting.

Members interested in contesting the election have been asked to submit nomination papers, which can be obtained from the MCD secretary's office. Duly filled nomination papers will be accepted by the civic body between 11 am and 5 pm on all working days till July 21, the notice said.

AGENCIES

FOCUS SHIFTS TO DIGITISATION

Four Delhi districts achieve 100% SIR form distribution

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Four districts in Delhi have achieved 100 per cent distribution of enumeration forms under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, marking the near-completion of the door-to-door exercise as booth-level officers shift their focus to collecting and digitising completed forms.

According to the cumulative status report issued by Delhi's Chief Electoral Officer on Thursday, four districts -- Old Delhi, New Delhi, North East and South have completed distribution of forms to all electors in their districts.

Overall, 1,44,44,600 forms have been distributed, covering 99.55 per cent of Delhi's 1.45 crore electors.

The number of digitised forms has risen to 26,02,654, taking digitisation to nearly 18 per cent of the electorate. With the distribution exercise virtually complete, election officials expect the pace of digitisation to pick up in the coming days.

The Election Commission on Wednesday revised the SIR schedule for Delhi.

House-to-house visits by booth-level officers (BLOs), earlier scheduled to conclude on July 29, will now continue till August 8.

The draft electoral rolls will be published on August

17, while the final electoral rolls will now be published on October 19, instead of October 7.

Meanwhile, claims and objections can be filed from August 17 to September 16 and will be disposed of by October 15.

While the extension gives BLOs more time, many said the challenge has now shifted from door-to-door visits to uploading thousands of completed forms through the Election Commission's mobile application.

"Everything has to be uploaded digitally. Learning the app, scanning documents and entering every detail correctly takes me much longer. Whenever there's a technical issue, I often seek help from my son or younger colleagues," said Manish, a teacher in his 50s serving as a BLO.

Another BLO, Abhishek, said the exercise remained time-bound despite the large number

of voters to be covered.

"There is pressure to move quickly because so many voters have to be covered," he said.

Many BLOs, most of whom are teachers, anganwadi workers and other government employees assigned election duty alongside or in place of their regular work, have also spoken of long hours, repeated visits to locked houses, and the pressure of meeting deadlines while ensuring accurate digitisation.

NEW DELHI: The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Friday alleged irregularities in the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Delhi, claiming that eligible voters, particularly from poor and migrant communities, were being left out of the exercise.

Addressing a press conference, Delhi AAP chief Saurabh Bharadwaj alleged that around 14 lakh voters had been removed during a pre-SIR exercise and claimed that they would

not be able to participate in the ongoing revision process.

He also alleged that enumeration forms had not been distributed in several low-income localities despite official records showing full distribution.

Bharadwaj further claimed that residents whose slum clusters had been demolished, including those rehabilitated in government-provided flats, were not being issued enumeration forms by Booth Level Officers (BLOs).

SIGNIFICANT VERDICT

Absence of train ticket alone cannot defeat railway-accident claim: SC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a significant verdict, the Supreme Court on Friday said the mere absence of a train ticket on the body of a deceased passenger cannot be a ground to deny compensation to the victim's family in a railway-accident case.

The ruling, aimed to strengthen the rights of railway passengers and their families, set aside the concurrent orders of the Railway Claims Tribunal (RCT) and the Madhya Pradesh High Court, and awarded a compensation of Rs 8 lakh to Lata, the widow of a man who died after falling from a running train in 2015.

A bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and N Kotiswar Singh allowed the appeal of the widow, whose compensation claim was rejected by the RCT and the high court on the ground that her husband



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

was not proved to be a bona-fide passenger because his ticket was not found after the accident.

The top court said the Railways Act is a beneficial welfare legislation and must receive a liberal and purposive interpretation.

Referring to earlier verdicts, Justice Karol, who authored the judgment, said, "The benefi-

cial legislations are to receive purposive and liberal construction in furtherance of the intentions of the legislature, as can be discerned, instead of a literal or restrictive approach being adopted. The overall idea is to make the intention so understood, functional."

The verdict said "technical approaches and lapses in procedure should not defeat the

Highlights

» The top court said the Railways Act is a beneficial welfare legislation and must receive a liberal and purposive interpretation

» 'The beneficial legislations are to receive purposive and liberal construction in furtherance of the intentions of the legislature, as can be discerned, instead of a literal or restrictive approach being adopted. The overall idea is to make the intention so understood, functional'

cents, without requiring any proof of negligence.

Relying on earlier decisions, the bench said, "Merely because the ticket of a train journey was not found on the person of the deceased, it will not change his status as a bona-fide passenger. It has been held that the initial burden of the claimant can be satisfied by way of an affidavit."

It observed that the claimant's initial burden can be discharged through a credible affidavit and surrounding circumstances, after which the burden shifts to the railways to rebut the claim.

The case arose from the death of Chandrakant Thakkar, who allegedly fell from the Ahmedabad-Howrah Mail train while travelling from Raipur to Ahmedabad in November 2015. His travel bag, which reportedly contained the train ticket, went missing after the accident.

Asaram's bail plea: We don't want any untoward thing to happen, says SC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: "We don't want any untoward thing to happen," the Supreme Court said on Friday while asking the Rajasthan government to take proper instructions about the health condition of self-styled godman Asaram, who is seeking interim bail on medical grounds.

The Rajasthan High Court on May 27 upheld the conviction and life sentence awarded to the octogenarian in a case of rape of a minor in 2013.

He has filed an application in the apex court seeking interim bail on health grounds.

The matter came up for hearing before a bench of justices M M Sundresh and P B Varale.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Rajasthan government, told the bench that the AIIMS has said that Asaram needs some lifestyle changes.

"We don't want ourselves to be blamed or yourself to be blamed," the bench observed while asking Mehta to take proper instructions about his



health condition.

Mehta said the state would file an affidavit by July 20.

"There is some bleeding because of some gastro problem but that appears to be a temporary phenomenon," the top law officer said, adding that Asaram was taking medication.

The bench said, "We will only say that please take appropriate instructions because we don't want any untoward thing to happen."

The counsel appearing for Asaram said he was a high-risk patient.

Mehta said three months ago, Asaram went to Ayodhya and Kashi Vishwanath and he walked everywhere.

The bench posted the matter for hearing on July 21.

On June 30, the apex court sought response from the Rajasthan government on Asaram's plea challenging the high court order which had upheld his conviction and life sentence in the case.

The top court had said that in the meanwhile, the medical facility that was extended to him till now should continue, subject to the satisfaction of the medical authority concerned.

It had also granted liberty to the petitioner to make an urgent mentioning, in case his condition deteriorates warranting emergency medical attention.

The high court had upheld Asaram's conviction in the case, but acquitted him of charges related to alleged gangrape and penetrative sexual assault on a child under the erstwhile Indian Penal Code and the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act.

However, the high court upheld his conviction under IPC Section 376(2)(F) pertaining to rape of the minor, thereby retaining the sentence of life imprisonment awarded by the trial court.

From Page 1 India enters

the capacity to carry around 2,600 passengers, demonstrating the technology's suitability for high capacity passenger services. Vaishnav said testing is underway on the Sonipat to Delhi section and added that the service would eventually operate between Jind and Delhi.

Calling the project a successful example of the Make in India campaign, Modi said, "Names of Jind, Sonipat and Haryana will come up whenever there is mention of hydrogen train. I congratulate the entire country." He also referred to the ongoing conflict in West Asia, saying India receives large quantities of petrol, diesel, LPG and fertilisers through the Strait of Hormuz, but despite disruptions over the past few months, the country's development had continued without interruption.

After flagging off the train, Modi dedicated to the nation and laid the foundation stone of projects worth Rs 14,700 crore in Haryana. The largest among them was the inauguration of the 157.92 km four lane, fully access controlled Delhi-Amritsar-Katra Expressway section, built at a cost of around Rs 9,680 crore. Part of the 667 km expressway, it is expected to reduce travel time between Delhi and Katra from about 14 hours to nearly six hours and cut the Delhi-Amritsar journey from around eight hours to four hours, while easing congestion on NH-44 and supporting tourism, logistics and industrial growth.

The prime minister also inaugurated the 33.81 km Ambala-Kala Amb Highway, unveiled the 40.60 km Jind-Gohana Greenfield Highway that will reduce travel time between the two towns from about two hours to 40 minutes, and laid the foundation stone of the 24.27 km Hansi-Barwala Brownfield Highway project. He inaugurated the elevated railway track at Kurukshetra to ease congestion at railway crossings and laid the foundation stone for a Sikh museum in Kurukshetra showcasing Sikh history, teachings and contributions to India's civilisation.

Healthcare projects also featured prominently in Haryana. Modi dedicated Pandit Neki Ram Sharma Government Medical College in Bhiwani, Maharishi Chyawan Medical College and Rao Tula Ram Hospital in Koriawas, Narnaul, to improve access to medical education, specialist healthcare and additional MBBS seats in the state.

In Chandigarh, Modi launched projects worth over Rs 4,700 crore, including the Advanced Mother and Child Centre and the Advanced Neurosciences Centre at PGIMER. He also laid the foundation stone of a 150-bed Critical Care Block under the Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission, besides inaugurating education infrastructure and road connectivity projects. Addressing the gathering, Modi said a developed India would require leadership in future technologies, healthcare, artificial intelligence, semiconductors and advanced manufacturing. He also highlighted the expansion of medical colleges, telemedicine services and Ayushman Bharat health infrastructure across the country.

The prime minister later travelled to Jalandhar, where he inaugurated and laid the foundation stone of rail and road projects worth Rs 5,470 crore. He dedicated 75 redeveloped railway stations across 20 states under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme, including four stations in Punjab, flagged off the Amritsar (Chheharta)-Varanasi Sant Ravidas Express, inaugurated

the Daultapur Chowk-Kartoli rail line worth about Rs 830 crore, flagged off the Kartoli-Ambala train service and launched national highway projects worth over Rs 3,070 crore, including a section of the Delhi-Amritsar-Katra Expressway and the Southern Ludhiana Bypass. Redeveloped stations were also inaugurated virtually in states including Chhattisgarh, Gujarat and Kerala as part of the nationwide railway modernisation programme.

Anurag Kumar

An engineering graduate, Kumar spent nearly two decades with the Intelligence Bureau, where he handled key assignments related to Jammu and Kashmir, VIP security and left-wing extremism. He also served at the Indian mission in Washington during his tenure with the agency. Officials said he worked closely with multiple security agencies to dismantle terror networks and counter militancy in Jammu and Kashmir. Before joining the IB on deputation, he served in various positions within the AGMUT cadre.

Kumar was awarded the Police Medal for Meritorious Service in 2010 and the President's Police Medal for Distinguished Service in 2016.

Officials said his immediate priorities as Delhi Police commissioner include strengthening the Capital's security architecture, maintaining law and order, intensifying action against organised crime and cybercrime, and enhancing counter-terror preparedness. Improving women's safety and overseeing VIP security, particularly in sensitive areas of the city, are also expected to remain key focus areas.

Golcha, a 1992-batch AGMUT cadre IPS officer, took over as Delhi Police commissioner after serving as Director General of Tihar Prisons. Following Kumar's appointment, he has been directed to report to the Lieutenant Governor of Delhi for his next assignment. Golcha is scheduled to retire in April next year.

India rebuts ex-Japan

in this regard. The project implementation is consistent with the shared objective of initiating the high-speed train project at the earliest possible," the ministry said.

Officials said the corridor was progressing according to the implementation plan agreed upon by both governments.

Makihara had earlier criticised India's handling of the project, saying unpredictability during negotiations had led to delays.

"The Shinkansen project in India is something that I was involved in personally. One thing that became clear during international negotiations and discussions was the frequent unpredictability of the Indian side. They just would not live up to their commitments. Even when promises were made, these would be easily broken," he said.

He further alleged that Indian negotiators pursued their own interests until the final stages of discussions.

"They were not done pursuing their own selfish agenda until the last moment. The minister responsible was quite tough to negotiate with. It is impossible to make any meaningful negotiation when the leadership acts like that. In deference to all those Japanese who worked hard on this initiative, I must confess that I consider the responsibility for the failure of this initiative to be solely that of India," he said.

Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnav has said India's first bullet train service is expected to begin operations on the Surat-Bilimora section in Gujarat from August 15, 2027.

The 508-km Mumbai-Ahmedabad High Speed Rail corridor is being built in phases using Japan's Shinkansen technology and is being financed through a low-interest Official Development Assistance (ODA) loan from Japan.

The project, which was delayed earlier due to land acquisition issues, the COVID-19 pandemic and other implementation challenges, has gathered pace in recent months. Construction of viaducts, bridges, stations and other civil works is underway across Gujarat and Maharashtra.

SIT seeks

to scrutinise the temple's donation counting system, alleged financial irregularities, banking transactions, the role of the accused and related documents. Fresh leads that emerged during custodial interrogation and recent recoveries are also being verified before the probe is concluded, sources said.

The SIT had submitted its preliminary report to the Uttar Pradesh government on June 23. The inquiry reportedly identified five major deficiencies in the temple's administrative, financial and operational systems.

According to sources, the investigation found serious lapses in the handling of donations from the point they were collected inside the temple complex until they were transported to the bank and counted. The absence of adequate security and monitoring during this process was cited as one of the key reasons that allowed alleged irregularities in donation management.

The probe also reportedly found that gold and silver ornaments offered by devotees were not being properly catalogued or recorded. In several instances, the storage and documentation of valuable jewellery did not meet prescribed standards, sources said.

The SIT is also understood to have questioned the process of appointments within the temple administration. It reportedly found that several appointments were made on recommendations rather than through prescribed procedures and eligibility norms, affecting administrative accountability.

Based on its findings, the SIT has recommended strengthening financial controls, improving transparency in donation management, fixing accountability and introducing reforms in administrative practices. The state government is examining these recommendations before deciding the next course of action, sources said.

Meanwhile, highly placed sources said Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath briefed Union Home Minister Amit Shah on the progress of the investigation during their meeting in New Delhi on July 14. The final report is expected to be placed before the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust at its meeting on July 22 after the remaining investigation is completed.

Amid the ongoing probe, the temple trust has launched a 10-day prayaschit ritual in accordance with Hindu religious traditions observed after incidents considered to have affected a temple's sanctity.

'Prayaschit Yagya' begins
Around 70 Vedic priests are conducting simultaneous rituals at the sanctum sanctorum, the parikrama path and other locations within the temple complex. The ceremonies include Vedic chanting, Rudrabhishek, havan and special prayers to Lord Ram.

Trust functionaries said the objective of the ritual is to seek forgiveness before the deity and restore the temple's

spiritual purity. The trust's treasurer said the true meaning of 'prayaschit' is to acknowledge mistakes and ensure they are never repeated. He said the temple's management and security systems are being strengthened to prevent any recurrence of such incidents.

Meanwhile, sources said Gopal Rao, who was overseeing temple construction, has left Ayodhya after being relieved of his responsibilities following the temple construction committee meeting on July 6. They said the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh has reassigned him, although his new place of posting has not been disclosed.

RBI Governor

rose to 4.38 per cent in June from 3.93 per cent in May, driven largely by rising food prices, while food inflation itself climbed to 5.32 per cent from 4.78 per cent.

Malhotra also pointed to the monsoon as a factor worth watching closely, given that agriculture supports a large share of the population and makes up about 17 per cent of GDP. On the rupee, he said its performance has held steady even as the dollar strengthened following the West Asia conflict, calling India's currency situation "normal" in global terms. He added that gross FDI touched a record USD 95 billion last year, with net FDI in the first two months of this financial year at around USD 7 billion, and said the external sector should stay resilient over the medium term.

The governor said inflation control remains the RBI's core mandate, working alongside growth rather than against it. He also noted bank credit growth stood at around 18 per cent year-on-year in June, up from 17.5 per cent in May, and encouraged banks to adopt AI responsibly to improve services while guarding against cybersecurity risks.

Iran retaliates

interior, including the capital Tehran.

Iran's Energy Ministry also acknowledged attacks on power infrastructure for the first time, urging residents in southern provinces to reduce electricity use. It said the region was facing extreme heat alongside damage to electrical infrastructure but did not specify the facilities affected.

The US Central Command said its latest operation struck dozens of targets before dawn, marking the sixth consecutive night of American airstrikes. Iran's state-run IRNA news agency reported that a tower overseeing commercial traffic at Chabahar port on the Gulf of Oman collapsed in one of the attacks. The port, developed with Indian support, is a major trade gateway for Afghanistan.

Iran retaliated by launching missiles at Qatar, where air defence systems intercepted incoming projectiles. Qatar's Interior Ministry said debris from the interceptions wounded a child. Qatar has also been acting as a mediator in efforts to end the conflict.

Iran also fired missiles toward Bahrain and Kuwait. Kuwaiti authorities said an attack damaged a power and water desalination plant, which is critical in a country where about 90 per cent of drinking water comes from desalination. Officials said the fire was extinguished and assessments were underway.

Jordan said it intercepted three Iranian missiles, while explosions were reported in Iraq's Kurdish region. An attack targeting the Iranian Kurdish dissident group Komala killed at least nine people, according to a security

Wangchuk

Continued from Page 1
Resignation and Rs 1 crore compensation for the families of students who allegedly died by suicide over the examination controversy.

According to the latest medical bulletin, Wangchuk lost another 350 grams in the past 24 hours, taking his total weight loss to around 9.5 kg. He now weighs 56.55 kg. Doctors recorded his blood pressure at 108/68 mm Hg, blood sugar at 80 mg/dL, pulse rate at 72 beats per minute and oxygen saturation at 96 per cent. While he remains mentally alert, doctors have warned of increasing muscle loss, mild dehydration and the risk of organ damage if the fast continues.

The Delhi High Court has directed authorities to monitor Wangchuk's health daily and provide medical assistance if required.

The condition of other hunger strikers has also worsened. The All India Students' Association said its activists Neha, Manish and Aameen were in severe condition, with Aameen facing the risk of hypovolemic shock due to dehydration, Neha's blood sugar dropping to 49 mg/dL and Manish losing more than 10 per cent of his body weight.

Support for the agitation continued to expand. Congress leader Pawan Khera visited the protest site on Friday, following visits or messages of support from leaders including Dimple Yadav, Arvind Kejriwal, Mamata Banerjee, Uddhav Thackeray and Akhilesh Yadav.

More than 60 prominent personalities, including Nobel laureate Abhijit Banerjee, writers Amitav Ghosh, Arundhati Roy and Kiran Desai, along with filmmakers Zoya Akhtar, Vishal Bhardwaj and Honey Trehan, appealed to Wangchuk to end his fast, calling him "our collective conscience". They also urged the government to begin dialogue with him. A separate group of academics, including Romila Thapar, Prabhat Patnaik, Utsa Patnaik, Zoya Hasan and Neera Chandhoke, questioned Pradhan's silence and urged him to accept moral responsibility.

Meanwhile, actor Aamir Khan's remarks that his "3 Idiots" character Phunsukh Wangdu was not based on Wangchuk sparked a political row. While Khan said he and the filmmakers did not know Wangchuk during the making of the 2009 film and wished for his health and well-being, leaders from the Congress, AAP and RJD criticised the timing and tone of his clarification, triggering a wider debate on social media.

MP: 400-year-old cannon stolen from Narwar Fort

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SHIVPURI: A nearly 400-year-old cannon has been allegedly stolen from the historic Narwar Fort in the Shivpuri district of Madhya Pradesh, a police official said on Friday.

The alleged theft was committed between Wednesday and Thursday night. Preliminary investigations suggest that some individuals reached the rear of the fort in a vehicle and fled with the piece of artillery kept there.

Karera Sub-Divisional Officer of Police Prashant Sharma said that police inspected the spot after being alerted and launched an investigation.

He said all possible angles are being looked into, including the involvement of an interstate or international smuggling ring.

According to initial information, the cannon had fallen from its designated place a few days ago, but it was not placed back in safe custody. Now, the same cannon has been stolen, said officials.

Deputy Director of the State Archaeology Department, Tarun Kumar Srivastava, called the matter "extremely serious". The official said he would visit Narwar Fort to review the security arrangements at the historical site.

MODI ATTACKS CONGRESS-LED UPA GOVERNMENT

PM: India’s development didn’t come to standstill despite oil supply crisis

OUR CORRESPONDENT

JIND: Indian Railways would have come to a standstill had the situation from the West Asia conflict arisen before 2014 because most trains then ran on diesel, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Friday while stressing that nearly 99 per cent of the network has been electrified in the 12 years of his government.

In a broadside against the Congress-led UPA government after flagging off India’s first hydrogen-powered train connecting Jind to Sonipat in Haryana, the Prime Minister said the country has “got another gain” because of big changes that had taken place in Indian Railways since his government came to power.

“You are seeing that for the past several months, war has been going on in West Asia, across the entire region of (Strait of) Hormuz, involving



PM Narendra Modi addresses the gathering during the foundation stone laying ceremony of various projects, in Jind PTI

Iran and the Gulf. It is through this sea route that India receives a huge quantity of petrol, diesel, LPG gas and fertilisers for our farmers. But for the last three to four months, this route has continuously remained a battlefield...,” he said.

Modi went on to ask what would have happened had this taken place before 2014 when his government came to power.

“The work of India’s Railways would have come to a

complete standstill. At that time, a large part of our country was such that our trains used to run on diesel only. Had diesel supplies been disrupted then, how would diesel-powered trains have operated?

“The country would have faced a massive crisis. But friends, this is not the situation of 2014. It is Modi who thinks well before and also turns solutions to problems into reality on the ground,” he said.

Highlights

» ‘In the past 12 years, nearly 99 per cent of India’s railway network has been electrified’

» Modi also spoke about his recent visits to Indonesia, Australia and New Zealand

never have been fully electrified and would have continued to rely on diesel,” he said.

But in the past 12 years, nearly 99 per cent of India’s railway network has been electrified and in Haryana, the railway network has been electrified 100 per cent, he said.

“As a result, despite the war and the resulting oil supply crisis, India’s railways did not come to a halt. The country’s development did not come to a standstill. Trains continued to run without interruption,” he said.

Modi also spoke about his recent visits to Indonesia, Australia and New Zealand and stated that India signed several agreements during these visits, which received widespread attention.

“However, one important subject did not receive as much discussion. It concerns the youth of our country, especially the youth of Haryana, and that is sports,” said Modi.

ACTOR SAYS WANGCHUK DIDN’T INSPIRE ‘3 IDIOTS’ ROLE

Aamir’s remark draws political backlash

NEW DELHI: Aamir Khan on Friday sparked a debate with his comments that his “3 Idiots” character of Phunsukh Wangdu was not based on Sonam Wangchuk, drawing criticism from parties like RJD, Congress and AAP, which said the actor was unwilling to take a stand out of fear of the ruling establishment.

Responding to a question at the London Indian Film Festival, Khan said neither he nor director Rajkumar Hirani or writer Abhijat Joshi knew Wangchuk when they made the 2009 blockbuster.

“No, that’s not true actually. That is a misconception. I didn’t know about Mr Sonam at that time when we were doing



Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk during a protest, at Jantar Mantar, in New Delhi, Friday PTI

this film ‘3 Idiots’... However, what Mr Sonam is doing is good work in any case. He doesn’t have to be based on the character of ‘3 Idiots’ for us to respect him and the work that he does,” Khan said.

Asked about Wangchuk’s hunger strike over alleged irregularities in the NEET examination, Khan said, “I

MEETING AHEAD OF MONSOON SESSION

‘NDA ministers discuss govt’s priority to get Bills passed’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A crucial meeting of the NDA group of ministers including Defence minister Rajnath Singh and Home minister Amit Shah ahead of the Monsoon session of Parliament was held at Kartavya Bhavan here on Friday.

The meeting, also attended by Union ministers and NDA allies Lallan Singh (JD-U), Jayant Chaudhary (RLD) and Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu (TDP), discussed the ruling coalition’s strategy in the upcoming Parliament session beginning July 20, sources said.

Defence minister Rajanath Singh presided over the meeting in which Women and Child Development minister Annpurna Devi was also present.

The sources said the meeting discussed government business for the upcoming session and the governments “priority” of converting two Ordinances into Acts of Parliament during the session.

Closer Look

» The meeting also attended by Union ministers and NDA allies Lallan Singh, Jayant Chaudhary and Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu

» The government plans to introduce the Income-tax (Amendment) Bill in the upcoming Monsoon session

The government plans to introduce the Income-tax (Amendment) Bill in the upcoming Monsoon session to replace the Ordinance effected to exempt foreign investors from income tax on interest earnings and capital gains from investment in G-secs.

The Ordinance was promulgated last month to attract foreign capital to ease pressure on the depreciating rupee due to the West Asia crisis.

The Income-tax (Amendment) Bill, 2026, will replace the Income Tax (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026.

The government also plans to introduce the Income-tax (Amendment) Bill in the upcoming Monsoon session to replace the Ordinance effected to exempt foreign investors from income tax on interest earnings and capital gains from investment in G-secs.

The Ordinance was promulgated last month to attract foreign capital to ease pressure on the depreciating rupee due to the West Asia crisis.

In the upcoming session, the government may also bring an amended women’s reservation Bill along with a delimitation Bill to seek its passage in Parliament, with NDA sources expressing confidence in getting the required two-thirds number with the support of various Opposition parties, including the Congress and the Samajwadi Party.

IN THE MIDST OF VOTING

JPC examining Bill on removal of PM, CMs defers adoption of draft report

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a dramatic development, a Joint Committee of Parliament examining a Bill on removal of prime minister and chief ministers detained on serious charges decided to defer the adoption of a draft report when voting was underway on each of the five recommendations made by the panel.

The joint committee on 130th Amendment Bill had made the five recommendations in its draft report which was circulated to members recently.

On Friday, when the committee was voting on each of the

recommendations separately, it was decided that more consultations with stakeholders and discussions among members were required.

AIMIM’s Asaduddin Owaisi and NCP (Sharad Pawar) MP Supriya Sule had submitted their dissent notes but withdrew them after the panel decided to defer the adoption in the last minute.

“The joint parliamentary committee unanimously said that we needed more consultations with stakeholders,” said panel chief Aparajita Sarangi (BJP).

Members present in the meeting said voting on two

of the recommendations was already done and discussions were underway on the third when the decision was taken to defer the adoption of the draft report.

Interestingly, a few ruling party members had also voted against the first two recommendations. However, these were adopted with majority votes.

The panel had recommended that the prime minister, Union ministers and chief ministers be suspended and not permanently removed from their posts, if they are detained for 30 straight days on charges of serious offences -- pending the outcome of legal proceedings.

Legacy of hunger strikes woven into warp and weft of India’s politics

Father of the nation undertook 18 fasts for various reasons

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Mahatma Gandhi, Bhagat Singh, Potti Sreeramulu, Irom Sharmila, Anna Hazare... And Sonam Wangchuk today. The list is long, the causes different, the means the same - fasting to register protest and make yourself heard.

From a few days to 16 years. The many hunger strikes of varying scale buried under the sands of time have tugged at the heartstrings of a nation that takes pride in its legacy of fasting against injustice as a protest tool.

Wangchuk’s fast unto death lies on the bedrock of hunger strikes through contemporary Indian history, starting with Gandhi and including Irom Sharmila who went off food for 16 years against the Armed Forces Special Powers Act (AFSPA) and holds the record for the longest hunger strike anywhere in the world.

“...a fast which a votary of non-violence sometimes feels impelled to undertake by way of protest against some wrong done by society, and this he does when he as a votary of Ahimsa has no other remedy left. Such an occasion has come my way.”

Gandhi, one of the strongest proponents of fasting as a way of protest, wrote this ahead of the last of his 18 fasts on January 13, 1948 from Birla House for restoration of communal peace across the nation. Two weeks later, he was assassinated in the same place.

The father of the nation undertook 18 fasts for various reasons, starting from a seven-day fast in Phoenix, South Africa, as penance for the inmates, followed by another daylong fast at the ashram for similar reasons.

The longest of his fasts lasted 21 days, including those

Key Points

» Gandhi’s idea of hunger strike found resonance in his followers, most prominently with freedom fighter Potti Sreeramulu

» In pre-independence India, the names of Bhagat Singh, Batukeshwar Dutt, and Jafindra Nath Das are remembered for leading a hunger strike in 1929

for Hindu-Muslim unity, against untouchability, and detention by the British without charges.

Gandhi’s idea of hunger strike found resonance in his followers, most prominently with freedom fighter Potti Sreeramulu.

The staunch Gandhian played a pivotal role in the creation of Andhra State. He started fasting in October 1952, demanding a separate state for Telugu speakers, something that prime minister Jawaharlal Nehru had resisted.

On the 58th day, he died. The region burst into the flames of violent protests, forcing the government to chalk out the land that later came to be known as Andhra Pradesh.

In death, Sreeramulu managed to change the country’s map through the sheer resolution of a hunger strike.

In pre-Independence India, the names of Bhagat Singh, Batukeshwar Dutt, and Jafindra Nath Das are remembered for leading a hunger strike in 1929 to improve prison conditions where they were held for the killing of John Saunders.

‘Gyanesh Kumar a ‘weapon of mass destruction’ for electoral rolls’

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Jairam Ramesh on Friday slammed Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar as a “complete weapon of mass destruction” for electoral rolls in the country and said the Opposition would push for his removal as the poll panel chief.

Opposition parties on April 24 had submitted a fresh notice in the Rajya Sabha seeking to move a motion for the removal of Kumar.

The Opposition’s fresh

charges on Kumar’s “proved misbehaviour” included “continued partisan asymmetry in the enforcement of the Model Code of Conduct”.

Asked whether the Opposition will push for action against Kumar on the notice submitted in April, Ramesh told news agency, “We haven’t heard anything on that. Absolutely, we have to push. I mean he’s a complete weapon of mass destruction as far as electoral rolls are concerned.”

Opposition parties on April 24 submitted a fresh notice in RS seeking to move a motion for removal of Kumar

“The most devastating indictment of Mr Gyanesh Kumar has come from a very senior IAS officer, who was the first director

general of the Unique Identification Authority of India, and has a culturally very important name -- Ram Sevak Sharma. He’s written an article detailing how damaging and devastating the entire SIR exercise has become,” the Congress general secretary in-charge communications said.

So, this is not just what the Congress party is saying or what Trinamool Congress is stating, Ramesh said.

“I mean this is a retired civil servant who has worked in the

Modi government, he was given important positions and he’s come out and of course retired election commissioners have come out very openly (against SIR),” Ramesh said.

He pointed out that Opposition parties submitted a notice on April 24 for moving a motion for the removal of the chief election commissioner.

“Mr Gyanesh Kumar is just executing what he’s told to do by the home minister (Amit Shah),” Ramesh alleged.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Principal Chief Materials Manager

Headquarters Office, Baroda House, New Delhi-110001

Mail ID: salenr365@gmail.com

No. 117-S/Sales/Auction Programme/2026-27

Dated 16.07.2026

e-AUCTION NOTICE for 'August & September-2026'

E-Auction of Jammu division will be conducted for disposal of Ferrous Scrap, Non Ferrous Scrap, Other Misc Scrap, Condemned Loco, Coaches and Wagons, Scrap Rail and other Scrap P. Way material etc. Used Lead Acid Batteries/Used Oil/Refused Oil etc. will be sold only to recyclers registered with State Pollution Control Board. E-Auction programme for JAT division for the month of Aug & Sept is as under.

e-AUCTION DATES for 'August-2026'

S. No	Depot /Division Auction conducting Unit	Auction Starting Time	1 st round date	2 nd round date	3 rd round date	4 th round date	5 th round date
1	Sr.DMM/JAT	10:30 AM	5	10	14	20	25

e-AUCTION DATES for 'September-2026'

S. No	Depot /Division Auction conducting Unit	Auction Starting Time	1 st round date	2 nd round date	3 rd round date	4 th round date	5 th round date
1	Sr.DMM/JAT	10:30 AM	7	11	17	22	28

1. The details of item to be sold in auction will be available in catalogue at www.ireps.gov.in

2. The intending purchasers may inspect the scrap material before the auction during working hours at nominated locations.

3. To participate in e-auction, purchasers need to get themselves registered with ireps. The details on last sold rates in auctions are available at www.railnet.gov.in.

4. For further details regarding registration and other conditions of e-auction, please visit Railway website www.ireps.gov.in

Serving Customers With A Smile

2471/2026

कार्यालय कार्यपालन अभियन्ता,
ग्रामीण यात्रिकी सेवा सभाग दन्तेवाड़ा जिला दक्षिण बस्तर दन्तेवाड़ा (छगग0)
// ऑनलाईन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना द्वितीय बार (क्रमांक-01) //

क्रमांक / 770 / , निविदा / ग्रा.या.सेवा / 2026-27 दन्तेवाड़ा दिनांक- 16.07.2026

1. एकीकृत पंजीयन प्रणाली अंतर्गत सक्षम श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से निम्नलिखित निर्माण कार्य हेतु ऑनलाईन (Online) ई-निविदा दिनांक 30/07/2026 तक आमंत्रित की जाती है :-

स. क्र.	कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (रु.लाख में)	कार्यालय में निविदा की मैन्युअल दस्तावेज जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि
1	जौनल निविदा-जनपद पंचायत कुआरकोड़ा एवं कटेकल्याण अंतर्गत (रामो ग्राम पंचायत हेतु) विभिन्न मदों में स्वीकृत रु. 30.00 लाख से कम लागत के भवन/मंच/नाली/सड़क/ बाऊंड्रीवाल/ पुलिया एवं अन्य प्रकार के निर्माण कार्यों का सम्पादन करना (विद्युतीकरण कार्य छोड़कर)	100.00 लाख (प्रत्येक जनपद पंचायत)	दिनांक 03/08/2026 शाम 5.00 बजे तक

2. उपरोक्त निर्माण कार्यों की निविदा की सामान्य शर्तें, धरोहर राशि, विस्तृत निविदा विज्ञापित, निविदा दस्तावेज व अन्य जानकारी विभागीय वेब साईट <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> में दिनांक 21/07/2026 से 30/07/2026 तक देखी/ डाऊनलोड की जा सकती है ।

कार्यपालन अभियन्ता
ग्रामीण यात्रिकी सेवा सभाग दन्तेवाड़ा जिला दक्षिण बस्तर दन्तेवाड़ा (छगग0)

G262702179/5

Office of the Resident Commissioner
New Jharkhand Bhawan, Government of Jharkhand
Bangla Sahib Road, New Delhi-110001
Short-term Tender Invitation Notice

Tenders are invited for the purchase of linen for the residential rooms of Jharkhand Bhawan, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi. The details of the required materials are as follows:

Serial No.	Description	Quantity
01	Double bed sheet with pillow cover (white, king size) branded (Cotton) (200-300TC)	96
02	Bath towel (white) branded Cotton, 450GSM (90cmx180cm)	72
03	Hand towel (white) branded Cotton, 650GSM	96
04	Pillow (standard) branded - 2 feet 4" - 1 feet 8"	48
05	Bathroom mat, branded - 2 feet / 1 feet 6.5"	24

The details regarding the tender are as follows:

01	Starting date and time of tender submission	21.07.2026 10:00 AM
02	Last date and time of tender submission	27.07.2026 01:00 PM
03	Date and time of opening technical bid	28.07.2026 01:00 PM
04	Validity of tender	90 days from the date of submission
05	After the opening of the technical bid, the date for opening the financial bid will be determined and successful tenderers will be informed.	

Contact can be made:
For detailed information and tender documents, interested tenderers can contact the following office:
Address: Office of the Chief Administrative Officer,
New Jharkhand Bhawan, Bangla Sahib Road,
New Delhi-110001
Telephone Number: 011-41475010
E-mail: jhbhawan@gmail.com
PR 385156 Cabinet(26-27)JD

S/d
(Prabhakar Ojha)
Chief Administrative Officer

‘SELF-EXPLANATORY’: MEA DEFENDS INDIA-JAPAN JOINT STATEMENT

India rejects Pak protest over terror reference

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India on Friday brushed aside Pakistan's objections to a reference to cross-border terrorism in a recent India-Japan joint statement and said the document "is self-explanatory" and reflects shared perspectives on regional security challenges.

The India-Japan joint statement, issued after talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his Japanese counterpart Sanae Takaichi on July 2 in New Delhi, had strongly condemned all forms of terrorism, including "cross-border terrorism from Pakistan".

Pakistan has lodged a strong protest with Japan over references to cross-border terrorism.

"I would say the joint statement that was adopted during the visit of the Prime Minister

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The India-Japan joint statement had strongly condemned all forms of terrorism, including 'cross-border terrorism from Pakistan'
- » Pakistan has lodged a strong protest with Japan over references to cross-border terrorism
- » The two prime ministers unequivocally and strongly condemned terrorism and



violent extremism in all its forms and manifestations, including cross-border terrorism from Pakistan'

of Japan to India has several issues addressed, which are of bilateral nature, and also on issues on which we have a certain viewpoint," External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said at a media briefing.

"I would say that our joint statement is self-explanatory," when he was asked about Pakistan's action," he said. His remarks came in

response to a question.

"The two prime ministers unequivocally and strongly condemned terrorism and violent extremism in all its forms and manifestations, including cross-border terrorism from Pakistan," the joint statement said.

It said Modi and Takaichi condemned the Pahalgam terror attack, and took note of the UN Security Council

Monitoring team linking it to The Resistance Front (TRF), a front for Pakistan-based Lashkar-e-Taiba.

"They also condemned in the strongest terms the terror incident in Delhi on November 10, 2025. They called for the perpetrators, organisers, and financiers of this reprehensible act to be brought to justice without any delay," the statement had said.

It said the two leaders also "called for concerted actions against all UN-listed terrorist groups and entities including Al Qaeda, ISIS/Daesh, Lashkar-e-Tayyiba (LeT), Jaish-e-Mohammad (JeM) and their proxies, and to take resolute actions to root out terrorists' safe havens."

A Pakistan foreign office spokesperson said on Thursday that a "strong demarche" was made to Japanese side through diplomatic channels.

"Whenever there is an engagement with India, India forces the inclusion of such references in its joint statements, not just with Japan but also with other countries," the spokesperson said.

To another question on Pakistan describing a warrant issued by an Indian court for LeT founder Hafiz Saeed in connection with the Pahalgam attack as a "politically

motivated", Jaiswal said Pakistan has sponsored cross-border terrorism for decades and used it as an instrument of state policy.

"The Pahalgam terror attack took several innocent lives. You all saw its barbarity. Our authorities have begun investigations in the matter and it continues," MEA spokesperson Jaiswal said.

"As far as cross-border terrorism is concerned, you are well aware of Pakistan's decades-long sponsorship and support for it, as also its continued use as an instrument of state policy," he said.

In connection with Islamabad's rejection of charges filed by the NIA against several Kashmiri separatist leaders in connection with an incident in 1996, Jaiswal said Pakistan has "no locus standi to comment on matters which are internal to India."

Chandigarh Press Club condemns attack on senior journalist Handa

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: The Chandigarh Press Club strongly condemns the assault on senior journalist Ramesh Handa by BJP workers while he was performing his professional duties on Friday morning.

Ramesh Handa, City Chief Editor (Chandigarh Region) of Punjab Kesari, was covering a news story related to the Prime Minister's visit to Chandigarh. He was at Sector 37 reporting on the movement of Chandigarh Transport Undertaking (CTU) buses ferrying BJP workers to PEC, Sector 12, the venue of the Prime Minister's programme.

Sources said that while Ramesh Handa was recording video footage on his mobile

INSIGHT

» Ramesh Handa, City Chief Editor (Chandigarh Region) of Punjab Kesari, was covering a news story related to the Prime Minister's visit to Chandigarh

» Sources said that while Ramesh Handa was recording video footage on his mobile phone, some "BJP workers", who were about to board a bus, objected to the recording. When he continued filming in the discharge of his professional responsibilities, they allegedly manhandled him, forcibly snatched his mobile phone, and took it away.

Such conduct is wholly unacceptable and amounts to an unlawful obstruction of a journalist in the lawful

discharge of his professional duties. Any attempt to intimidate, assault, or prevent media personnel from carrying out their work strikes at the very foundation of press freedom and the public's right to receive information. The Press Club demanded a fair and time-bound investigation into the incident and strict action against those found responsible in accordance with the law.

CHANDIGARH: Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) national convenor Arvind Kejriwal and Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Friday joined thousands of devotees at the 'Ek Shaam Bhagwan Shiv Ke Naam' bhajan sandhya in Pathankot, highlighting the state government's efforts to promote religious harmony and preserve spiritual traditions.

Addressing the gathering, Kejriwal said the Bhagwant Mann government has undertaken several initiatives to celebrate and promote the heritage of all faiths, including the 350th Shaheed Diwas of Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji and the 650th Parkash Purab of Sri Guru Ravidass Ji Maharaj.

He said 'Ek Shaam Bhagwan Shiv Ke Naam' programmes are



being organised across all 22 districts of Punjab and claimed that such large-scale events were being held in the state for the first time.

Announcing an expansion of the Mukh Mantri Tirath Yatra Yojana, Kejriwal said three new pilgrimage routes to Khatu Shyam Ji-Salasar Ji, Haridwar-Rishikesh and Mathura-Vrindavan would be

launched from August 1, benefiting around 1.5 lakh pilgrims.

The AAP chief also announced that beneficiaries of the Mawan Dhiyan Satkar Yojana whose registrations have been completed but payments are pending would receive the money directly in their bank accounts on August 1. Kejriwal further said the Punjab government is renovating the historic Kali Mata Mandir in Patiala at a cost of Rs 80 crore and has decided to build a grand temple dedicated to Sita Mata and Luv Kush near the Bhagwan Valmiki Mandir in Amritsar.

Mann said Punjab's tradition of communal harmony remains its biggest strength and asserted that the state would never allow the "seed of hatred" to grow on its soil.

MPOST

Punjab expands Tirath Yatra scheme, announces new routes

FEMA CASE

RBI issues compounding order against Gujarat firm

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has compounded multiple violations of the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA), 1999, by Apothecon Pharmaceuticals Private Limited after the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) issued a No Objection Certificate (NOC), bringing the probe into the matter to a close.

According to the ED, the RBI passed the compounding order on July 6 after the company agreed to pay a one-time compounding fee of Rs 40.52 lakh under Section 15 of FEMA.

The investigation was initiated after the ED received information regarding several FEMA violations by the company. These included delays in reporting foreign inward remittances, failure to file statutory reports such as the Advance Reporting Form (ARF), FC-GPR and Foreign Liabilities and Assets (FLA) returns, issuance of shares before receipt of foreign remittances, allotment of shares beyond the prescribed period and allotment of shares without the requisite government approval. The transactions involved foreign exchange proceeds amounting to several crores of rupees.

During the probe, the company approached the RBI seeking compounding of the violations. The RBI subsequently sought an NOC from the ED, which found the case eligible for compounding under the Foreign Exchange (Compounding Proceedings) Rules, 2024, and raised no legal objection. The ED said FEMA is primarily a civil statute aimed at promoting voluntary compliance and that compounding proceedings help resolve disputes without prolonged litigation. It clarified that violations involving money laundering, terror financing or national security concerns cannot be compounded.

Following the RBI's order, the proceedings against the company in respect of the compounded FEMA violations have been concluded.

CM: Redeveloped Kalka, Narwana stations to boost Haryana's growth

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi for inaugurating the redeveloped Kalka and Narwana railway stations under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme, saying the projects would strengthen connectivity and boost the state's economic growth.

Addressing a gathering at Kalka railway station, Saini said 34 railway stations across Haryana are being upgraded with modern passenger amenities and infrastructure at a cost of Rs 1,149 crore. He added that the redevelopment of Mandi Dabwali, Hodal and Jind railway stations has already been completed and these stations have been transformed into 'Amrit Railway Stations'.

A live telecast of Prime Minister Modi's programme from Jalandhar was screened



Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini interacts with people at Kalka market

during the event, where the Prime Minister dedicated 75 redeveloped Amrit Railway Stations across the country to the nation through video conferencing.

Describing the day as historic, Saini said the Prime Minister had gifted Haryana nine major development projects worth nearly Rs 15,000 crore, including the country's first hydrogen-powered train. He

noted that the railway budget for Haryana has increased from Rs 315 crore in 2014 to Rs 3,566 crore in 2026-27.

The Chief Minister said railway projects worth around Rs 12,000 crore are currently under implementation in the state and are creating new opportunities in industry, trade, tourism and employment. He also highlighted that Haryana has achieved 100 per cent electrification of its 1,574-km railway network.

Saini said Haryana is currently served by eight Vande Bharat Express trains and two Amrit Bharat Express trains. He also highlighted major infrastructure projects, including the Rohtak-Meham-Hansi and Sonapat-Jind rail lines and the Haryana Orbital Rail Corridor, which he said would transform the state's industrial and economic landscape.

MPOST

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: The Supreme Court on Friday sharply criticised a private hospital and one of its doctors for allegedly refusing emergency treatment to a four-year-old girl who was allegedly raped and murdered in Ghaziabad, calling their conduct "merciless, ruthless and insensitive". The child later succumbed to her injuries, prompting the court to question whether timely medical intervention could have made a difference.

A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, along with Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana, said every doctor has a professional and moral obligation to provide immediate medical assistance to victims of serious crimes, regardless of their financial background. The judges observed that if the hospital lacked the required facilities,

THE CASE

- » The observations came during the hearing of a petition arising from the alleged rape and murder of the four-year-old girl in Ghaziabad
- » The Bench also cautioned the hospital that its conduct could invite



serious consequences and indicated that the matter would be taken up again next week, preferably on July 21

the doctor should have ensured the child was immediately shifted to another medical centre instead of turning her away. "You have no business writing 'doctor' before your name if you do not perform your duty," the Bench remarked, asking whether the child was denied treatment because her family was poor and unable to pay. The court further said a compassionate doctor would have personally accompanied the victim to another hospital

to ensure she received urgent medical care.

The observations came during the hearing of a petition arising from the alleged rape and murder of the four-year-old girl in Ghaziabad. The Bench also cautioned the hospital that its conduct could invite serious consequences and indicated that the matter would be taken up again next week, preferably on July 21.

The case has already drawn strong criticism from the apex

court over the manner in which the investigation was initially handled. At an earlier hearing, the Supreme Court had pulled up the Ghaziabad Police for delaying the registration of the FIR and failing to invoke rape and Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act charges despite the post-mortem report recording injuries to the child's private parts.

The court had also questioned why the case was initially treated only as a murder investigation and remarked that there appeared to be a "hush-hush approach" in handling the matter.

It directed the Ghaziabad Police Commissioner and the SHO of Nandgram police station to appear personally before the court and explain the sequence of events, while stressing that investigations into crimes against children must be prompt, sensitive and thorough.

SC raps hosp for refusal to treat rape victim

Punjab: 309 held in anti-gangster drive

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Police on Friday conducted 580 raids at identified locations linked to associates of gangsters across the state as part of its ongoing anti-gangster campaign, "Gangstran Te Vaar".

The campaign, launched by Director General of Police (DGP) Gaurav Yadav on January 20, aims to make Punjab a gangster-free state. On Day 178 of the drive, police teams from all districts, in coordination with the Anti-Gangster Task Force (AGTF), arrested 309 persons and recovered seven weapons.

The total number of arrests under the campaign has reached 49,912. Preventive action was also taken against 241 individuals, while eight proclaimed offenders were apprehended during the operation.

Punjab Police also continued its anti-drug drive, "Yudh Nashian Virudh", for the 503rd consecutive day. During the operation, 64 "drug smugglers" were arrested and 1.6 kg of heroin, 118 intoxicant pills and Rs 3.79 lakh in drug money were recovered.

MPOST

Nation Briefs

AMRAVATI DIVISION SEES 415 FARMER SUICIDES BETWEEN JAN-JUNE 2026

AMRAVATI: A total of 415 farmers committed suicide between January and June this year in Maharashtra's Amravati division, officials said on Friday. Citing data from the office of the Amravati divisional commissioner, they said the highest number of suicides, 82, took place in June. "Amravati division recorded 62 farmer suicides in January, 64 in February, 68 in March, 76 in April, 63 in May and 82 in June. Yavatmal led with 128 suicides in the January to June period, followed by Akola at 80, Amravati at 76, Buldhana at 69 and Washim at 62," an official said. Of these, 144 cases are eligible for compensation, while 88 are not and 183 are under investigation. Assistance has been given in 27 cases so far.

SC ALLOWS RELEASE OF FILM 'MAHAPRABHU JAGANNATH' POST LORD JAGANNATH YATRA

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday permitted the all India release of animated film 'Mahaprabhu Jagannath' on or after July 28 post Lord Jagannath Yatra festivities. A bench of Justices BV Nagarathna and R Mahadevan noted that the animated movie was based on a web series already released on Youtube, and that the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) had granted clearance for its screening. The producers of the film, which was scheduled to be released Friday, had challenged the July 15 order of the Orissa High Court which restrained Ele Animations Pvt Ltd from releasing the movie.



EDITORIAL

COSMIC ‘RACE’

India's space programme has always occupied a unique place in the national imagination. It has been one of independent India's greatest success stories—a model of scientific excellence, fiscal prudence and strategic autonomy. Missions such as Chandrayaan, Mangalyaan, Aditya-L1 and the recent Spa-DeX docking experiment have demonstrated that India can achieve technological breakthroughs at costs that astonish the world. The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has therefore become much more than a government agency; it is a symbol of national capability. Yet the organisation now confronts a challenge that is unfamiliar in its history. It is not grappling with budgetary constraints, technological setbacks or international sanctions. Instead, it is facing a gradual but significant outflow of experienced scientists. Reports that more than 100 scientists have resigned or opted for voluntary retirement have prompted the Department of Space to tighten approval procedures for those associated with strategic missions such as Gaganyaan. While the number represents less than one per cent of ISRO's workforce, the concern lies not in the quantity but in the quality of the expertise being lost. Space science is among the few disciplines where decades of accumulated experience often matter more than numerical strength. Every departure represents years of institutional memory, engineering judgement and mission-tested knowledge that cannot be recreated through fresh recruitment alone. The development should therefore be viewed not as an isolated administrative issue but as an important signal of the changing dynamics of India's rapidly evolving space ecosystem.

Ironically, the reasons behind this trend reflect one of India's greatest policy successes. The opening of the space sector to private participation after 2020 has fundamentally transformed an industry that was once almost entirely government-led. The establishment of IN-SPaCe, greater private investment and a more liberal regulatory environment have encouraged the emergence of an impressive ecosystem of startups and commercial enterprises. Companies such as Skyroot Aerospace, Agnikul Cosmos, Pixxel, Belatrix Aerospace, Dhruva Space, Digantra, GalaxEye and SatSure are today designing launch vehicles, satellites, propulsion technologies, earth observation systems and commercial applications that were once the exclusive domain of ISRO. Venture capital has flowed into the sector, global collaborations have expanded and India has emerged as one of the world's fastest-growing space startup destinations. Naturally, this has widened career choices for scientists and engineers. Higher salaries, employee stock ownership plans, faster promotions, flatter organisational hierarchies and greater opportunities to lead projects from conception to execution make private companies attractive destinations. Many of these firms are founded or mentored by former ISRO veterans, allowing young engineers to continue working within the same technological ecosystem while enjoying entrepreneurial freedom. The migration of talent, therefore, is not merely a story of better pay; it is evidence that India's space economy has matured enough to generate healthy competition for the country's finest scientific minds.

At the same time, the departures also expose structural weaknesses that cannot be ignored. Government research organisations, by their very nature, operate within elaborate administrative systems designed to ensure accountability, transparency and procedural compliance. While these safeguards are necessary in public institutions handling strategic technologies, they often slow decision-making and reduce organisational agility. Several serving and former officials have privately pointed to growing frustrations over delays in approvals, increasingly centralised decision-making and bureaucratic processes that sometimes impede scientific autonomy. These concerns have become more visible as ISRO's mission portfolio has expanded to include human spaceflight, reusable launch systems, docking technologies and planetary exploration. Recent delays affecting the Gaganyaan programme, SSLV operations, GSVL launches and industry-built PSLV missions have further reinforced perceptions that execution has become more cumbersome. Whether every criticism is fully justified is less important than recognising its impact on morale. Scientists are, by temperament, problem-solvers. They thrive in environments that reward innovation, speed and technical independence. When engineers find themselves spending more time navigating administrative procedures than solving engineering challenges, frustration becomes inevitable. Private firms, with their smaller teams and leaner structures, naturally appear more appealing to ambitious professionals eager to see ideas transformed rapidly into operational technologies.

This matters because space programmes depend disproportionately on specialised human capital. Designing a launch vehicle or a planetary spacecraft is not simply an exercise in applying textbook knowledge. It involves years of accumulated experience in system integration, mission planning, propulsion, navigation, thermal management, software validation and learning from previous failures and successes. Such expertise is developed through repeated participation in missions rather than classroom instruction. As India prepares for some of its most ambitious programmes—including Gaganyaan, Chandrayaan-4, the Bharatiya Antariksh Station, the Venus Orbiter Mission and reusable launch vehicle technologies—the continuity of experienced scientific leadership becomes indispensable. Losing seasoned engineers during this critical phase risks creating knowledge gaps that cannot be filled immediately by newly recruited graduates, however talented they may be. The Department of Space's decision to subject resignations from scientists associated with strategic missions to higher levels of approval is understandable from the standpoint of national interest. Yet restrictions alone cannot become the principal instrument of talent management. Around the world, successful space powers such as the United States and members of the European Space Agency have embraced hybrid ecosystems where government agencies, universities, research institutions and private industry coexist, collaborate and exchange talent. NASA retains its leadership not because scientists are prevented from leaving, but because it continues to offer opportunities to work on frontier research, deep-space exploration and technologies that remain beyond the commercial horizon. India must gradually evolve towards a similar model in which mobility across institutions strengthens, rather than weakens, the national innovation ecosystem.

STRATEGIC SKIES



KDP RAO

THE WRITER IS A FORMER ADDITIONAL CHIEF SECRETARY OF CHHATTISGARH

Airports are no longer mere gateways; they have become instruments of soft power, connectivity, and economic influence

Geoeconomics of Aviation

As aviation reshapes global trade and diplomacy, India must move beyond domestic growth and position itself as the world's next major international hub

Normally, a robust aviation sector acts as a catalyst for exponential growth through multiplier effects in countries with abundant natural resources and assured domestic demand. But, unusually and surprisingly, aviation has become an economic resource in itself for some countries that have neither natural resources nor the quintessential factors of production, boosting their growth phenomenally and making them geopolitical powers. The magic lies in 'geoeconomics'. Today, Dubai in the United Arab Emirates, Singapore in Southeast Asia, and Turkey—the bridge between Europe and Asia—have become geopolitical powers largely due to sustained investment in aviation programmes, building world-class airports catering to 100–200 million passengers globally every year, one-third of whom are transit passengers. While Dubai Airport's (DXB) annual direct revenue is roughly \$3.8 billion, its overall economic impact adds approximately \$22–26.7 billion annually to Dubai's GDP. Similarly, Singapore's Changi Airport Group's revenue reached US\$2.4 billion for FY 2026. As masters of global air connectivity, these countries wield a tremendous amount of political and economic influence in the world.

Can India also leverage its aviation sector to take advantage of geoeconomics? The answer could be in the affirmative, in view of the sector's pre-pandemic growth of more than 10 per cent CAGR. Tremendous growth has been observed in India's aviation sector in recent years. Dozens of modern airports are coming up across the country under UDAN, transporting around 174 million O-D passengers (the third highest globally), though the sector is primarily dominated by domestic travel (78 per cent), which largely sustains the industry (IATA, June 2025). Aviation (airlines, airports, MRO, ground handling, etc.) directly adds to GDP through revenues, taxes, and spending. In India, it contributed cumulatively about USD 53.6 billion and supported 7.7 million jobs overall, as per recent assessments. Delhi is aiming to increase its capacity to 100 million passengers by 2030. But can it replicate the Dubai or Singapore model?

Dubai International (DXB) is an example of turning one's disadvantage into an advantage with the help of vision and strategy. A desert was transformed into an international aviation hub to connect 80 per cent of the world's population within an eight-hour flight radius. Hundreds of secondary cities with no



Global aviation is increasingly becoming an instrument of economic statecraft

direct international connectivity were provided access by the state-run Emirates Airline. The UAE, through the massive expansion project at Al Maktoum International Airport, has built a system of structural dependency for the world worth billions. Singapore is just a city-state of 5.9 million people, with no noteworthy natural resources or a significant domestic market. Surprisingly, Changi Airport catered to 70 million passengers in 2025. It is not just an airport but a huge national, man-made economic asset facilitating the global flow of people, capital, and cargo. Similarly, Turkey leveraged its strategic location by expanding Istanbul Airport into one of the best-connected airports in the world, providing political and commercial access to markets that other countries could not. In 2025, Istanbul Airport served 84 million passengers, of whom 36 million were transit passengers who never stepped out of the terminal. It connects 309 destinations across 110 countries, including many in Africa that most Western airlines have shied away from. It has surpassed even Heathrow, Charles de Gaulle, and Frankfurt, not to mention major airports in the United States. China handled around 1.5 billion passenger trips in 2025 and is reportedly investing heavily in international aviation as part of its Belt and Road Initiative.

Airports are no longer mere gateways; they are instruments of 'soft power' and influence, along with being drivers of income. Infrastructure investment, operational strategy, and the accumulation of connectivity will determine which country moves ahead of the others in the race. Analysts believe that

the future global balance of power will depend not only on military capabilities or political influence but also on who succeeds in building mega aviation networks and world-class terminals, outsmarting the existing aviation hubs.

India, with 65–68 per cent of its population in the working-age group, strong economic fundamentals, and a huge domestic market—not to mention political stability—is definitely poised to emerge as one of the world's major aviation hubs within the next decade. India occupies a central position in South Asia by virtue of its geography and can serve as a bridge between the East and the West. It has proximity to the Middle East, Europe, Africa, and Southeast Asia. Remittances flow from its diaspora, while trade links with Gulf nations ensure natural traffic flows. Projections forecast that India will emerge among the world's top three aviation players in the long term. Reportedly, plans to develop Delhi, Mumbai, and Bengaluru as transit hubs to challenge Gulf carriers are already underway.

Airports in India have doubled from 74 in 2014 to 159 by 2024. Under the UDAN scheme, hundreds of regional routes have become operational, connecting Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities through more than 90 airports and over 600 routes. According to the PIB, ₹4,023.37 crore as Viability Gap Funding (VGF) has been disbursed to promote connectivity to underserved and remote regions. The positive effects are, of course, visible in tourism, healthcare access, and overall trade. Private players like Adani have undertaken major capex projects involving the construction and expansion of multiple airports.

GMR's airports in Delhi and Hyderabad are making huge investments in expansion, developing aerocities and cargo terminals that are clearly visible to passengers during take-off or landing. The National Civil Aviation Policy (NCAP) 2016 targets massive growth in passenger traffic and cargo movement. The market continues to be sustained by low-cost flights, whose demand is assured by the growth of the middle class and rising disposable incomes.

However, to compete with Dubai or Singapore, India has to address certain structural challenges in the sector. First, current operations are insufficient even to handle point-to-point domestic traffic efficiently, while transit traffic remains limited, with nearly 85 per cent still routed through Gulf hubs. Second, service quality, immigration and security delays, skill shortages, dependence on overseas MRO services, and high operating costs make the competition stiff. Third, unpredictable profits, fuel price shocks, regulatory issues, and the near monopoly of a few operators such as IndiGo and Air India make airline economics complex and less attractive. Last but not least is the uncertainty arising from policy issues such as ownership rules, taxation, bilateral agreements, and coordination between the Centre and the states.

The ongoing Middle East conflict has dented Dubai's reputation as a secure and invulnerable aviation hub. India, as a peaceful country with zero tolerance for terrorism, commands respect among nations and can emerge as an ideal alternative international aviation transit point. As a fast-growing economy with enormous natural resources, India should embark on a mission to fill this vacuum by creating world-class aviation hubs. Superior infrastructure, coupled with operational efficiency, is the need of the hour to ensure hassle-free connectivity, faster processing, high-end amenities, and large cargo-handling facilities. Open policies are needed to encourage liberal bilateral agreements, tax incentives, and integration with broader ecosystems in tourism, finance, trade, and real estate (including aerotropolises). A route expansion strategy must be pursued aggressively to guarantee enhanced ease of doing business. Needless to say, a far-sighted vision that transforms airports into economic assets capable of fuelling growth and enhancing India's geopolitical influence should be the guiding force. India can do it.

Views expressed are personal

AT VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

Our senior population, which stood at 142 million (60 years and over) in 2021, is slated to touch 231 million in the next 10 years, and between 340 million and 350 million by 2051

Silver Care

India's fast-ageing population demands support, but are current services meeting quality, safety, and affordability?

What's the most precious commodity in life? Family, wealth, influence? As we age, it becomes inordinately clear that nothing, absolutely nothing, tops health. Even as India moves forward, fuelled by the agility and exuberance of youth, a vast proportion of our nation's population is ageing fast. If you are in charge of the upkeep of your aged parents, you know this feeling already. I have lost track of how many times I have wanted to turn back time and return to my school-going self to prevent my parents from leading a reckless life. Frustration, resentment, sadness, and financial and emotional drain are commonplace if you bear the brunt of caring for your parents, especially if they have led indisciplined, unplanned lives. And while I have no statistics to support it (yet), it's unbelievable how a majority of our elders paid scant regard to health during their heyday. Maybe they were flower children, maybe it was just the paucity of available information during their time—but our parents' generation, at least mine and many within my age group, lived life on their own terms and are now, in a way, paying for it with the infirmities of old age. Whatever the reason, if your parents are saddled with disease, then the saga is as painful for you as it is for them. And there's more to come. Our 12 per cent senior citizen demographic is rapidly turning into 19.5 per cent, and it has opened a Pandora's box of problems and possibilities.

Our senior population, which stood at 142 million (60 years and over) in 2021, is slated to touch 231 million in the next 10 years, and between 340 million and 350 million by 2051. These numbers, coming from CARE Ratings, show that a staggering 21 per cent of our population will require care, and that means laying the foundation from now. As per the United Nations Population Fund, one in seven Indians will be a senior citizen within the next decade. It's inarguable that, in this scenario, both the elderly and their progeny need support. For many seniors, their children may be living away in another city or country,



As families shrink and children move away, private eldercare services are stepping in to bridge the gap

or are simply absent, leaving them to fend for themselves. A growing population of silver citizens has led to the emergence of a segment that must be serviced. Sensing this opportunity, the market has witnessed a host of eldercare services, assisted living facilities, continuum and palliative care units, and home-care set-ups. At least a few hundred such eldercare companies currently operate in India, with many more sprouting every day. Some of these companies are attracting hefty private capital, with investors also sniffing the prospects of a market worth Rs 73,000 crore (as of 2024) and expanding.

The service provided by eldercare companies is a godsend; I say so from personal experience. From providing care managers who help with daily tasks such as grocery shopping to seamlessly handling hospitalisation, to supplying live-in attendants and shift-based nurses, these companies are filling a huge lacuna that exists at the social and familial level. At-home care is seeing enthusiastic adoption as more and more seniors and families prefer to be treated at home to avoid unnecessary hospitalisation and exposure to secondary infections. Physiotherapy, dance and music therapy, and counselling are additional services that

can further help senior citizens who have mobility or cognitive issues. Preventive care is another area that is surfacing in order to avoid ailments, accidents, and the neglect of seniors; it also makes prudent long-term fiscal sense.

But with any kind of proliferation, there will be concerns too. The eldercare sector reels under the burden of a lack of trained medical professionals. Nurses and medical personnel may not have adequate experience or may deliver services without supervision. Among them, attendants are the lowest on the rung, with only a few having certified experience; the rest wing it on the job. Proper training, sensitisation, and awareness-building for payroll and outsourced staff remain major areas of concern. If you are availing yourself of a service that extends to patient care for your parents, then there is no way you can remain hands-off. Mistakes are made often, confusion overflows, and while there is crucial support, you remain the primary caregiver and coordinator, even from afar. For more autonomous management, there are assisted living and palliative care centres for terminally ill patients.

Let's also accept that availing of such eldercare services is currently an option

for financially well-planned seniors or those funded by financially able children. The services cost a pretty penny, which may be worthwhile for affluent people, but they are a strain and nearly impossible for common folk. Reports suggest that India has only 300–350 geriatricians serving around 150 million elderly people today, and just 696 senior citizen homes functioning with government aid. Which brings me to the most important part of this column. While we can celebrate the passionate interest of private companies, what about the role of the government? There must be government infrastructure in place that can help senior citizens who cannot afford the route of expensive private services. At present, the central government provides Rs 5 lakh of health insurance aimed at senior citizens above 70 years of age. This year's Union Budget announced plans to train 1.5 lakh geriatric caregivers. The government is also providing up to Rs 1 crore in equity funding to startups under the SAGE (Seniorcare Ageing Growth Engine) initiative that are innovating or providing housing for senior citizens. On paper, there is the JEEVAN mobile app, the Senior Citizens Portal, elder protection laws, and a government scheme to fund homes for the elderly and distribute free assisted-living devices to low-income seniors. While these initiatives read well, on-the-ground implementation and access are far from ideal. We can learn from Japan, where the government began old-age planning in 2000 by making it compulsory for those aged 40 years and above to pay insurance premiums. With subsidised support, multi-level assistance, community care, AI, robotics, and tech-led preparedness, Japan is now one of the world leaders when it comes to eldercare. The stark reality is that a child's guilt never goes away, old age is not reversible, and illness can catch even the best of us off guard. But the government and eldercare companies can make life a tad easier for all stakeholders, provided they plug the gaps.

Views expressed are personal

Israel's Parl dissolves ahead of Oct 27 polls

TEL AVIV: Israel's parliament dissolved early Friday after passing a marathon of bills in the last moments of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's governing coalition.

The Knesset will not reconvene before the elections scheduled on Oct 27.

The expected dissolution comes as Netanyahu is struggling to hold onto power ahead of the next elections as Israel grinds toward the third anniversary of the Oct 7 attack that sparked nearly three years of war.

Israeli polls are showing a groundswell of support for opposition parties, led by former Prime Minister Naftali Bennett and a popular centrist former military chief.

The expected dissolution comes as Netanyahu is struggling to hold onto power ahead of the next elections as Israel grinds toward the third anniversary of the Oct 7 attack that sparked nearly three years of war.

Israeli polls are showing a groundswell of support for opposition parties, led by former Prime Minister Naftali Bennett and a popular centrist former military chief.

The expected dissolution comes as Netanyahu is struggling to hold onto power ahead of the next elections as Israel grinds toward the third anniversary of the Oct 7 attack that sparked nearly three years of war.

Over the past week, the Knesset passed several controversial laws in marathon sessions as Netanyahu attempted to ram through several of his pet projects.

Earlier this week, the Knesset passed two bills that effectively halt the enlistment of ultra-Orthodox men in the military in an attempt to ensure ultra-Orthodox parties join Netanyahu's coalition in the next government.

Powerful 7.4 quake hits Mexico coast near Guatemala

TAPACHULA: A strong earthquake struck the southern Mexican Pacific coast on Friday, right on the border with Guatemala, and was felt from Mexico City to El Salvador.

Authorities have not immediately reported any severe damage or casualties in any country.

The US Geological Survey (USGS) reported that the earthquake had a magnitude of 7.3 with the epicentre 48 kilometres southwest of Aquiles Serdan, near the coast of Chiapas and at a depth of 15 kilometres. It was preceded by a smaller quake with an epicentre a bit farther out in the ocean.

There were at least five aftershocks between magnitude 5.1 and 6, according to USGS.

Ukraine fights under interim defence chief

The war-torn country in recent months gained traction in the war

KYIV: Ukraine fought Russia's more than 4-year-old invasion under an interim defence minister on Friday, a day after a government reshuffle exposed a deep split between the military's old guard and young innovators over how to fight the war.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy's major shake-up of his government on Thursday,

which included the dismissal of Mykhailo Fedorov as defence minister and the appointment of a new prime minister, unsettled the country's military leadership and triggered a public outcry.

It tested Zelenskyy's authority and was an unwelcome difficulty after Ukraine in recent months gained traction in the war.

Zelenskyy said he had asked Maj. Gen. Yevhen Khmara, acting head of the state's security service and a highly regarded special operations expert, to take over the defence minister's duties.

Zelenskyy said late Thursday he would ask Parliament to formally approve Khmara's appointment as defence minister, as required by law.

That step could be delayed by bureaucratic hurdles, however. Ukrainian law requires the defence minister to be a civilian, so a serving soldier or security service officer must leave active duty before being formally appointed.

Also, lawmakers will be on summer recess through mid-August. It was not clear whether Khmara would have

enough votes in Parliament to be confirmed in the job.

Relations between 35-year-old Fedorov and Gen. Oleksandr Syrskyi, the 60-year-old commander of Ukraine's armed forces who started his military career in the former Soviet Union, had broken down, according to Zelenskyy, and made Fedorov's position untenable.



GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
Maharashtra Medical Goods Procurement Authority, Mumbai
MMGPA, 1st Floor, Arogya Bhavan, St. Georges Hospital Compound, Mumbai
Contact No:- 022-22621886 /022-22621973 Email:- maha.mmmpa2023@gmail.com

Tender Notice

Date:-17/07/2026

Chief Executive Officer, Maharashtra Medical Goods Procurement Authority, Mumbai invites tender in two envelope system from the eligible bidders for the following items for purchase of medicines.

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Name of Item(s)	Pre-Bid Meeting	Period of sale, download & submission of bid	Bid Opening
1	E-308	BPHU Equipment	Date: 24/07/2026 At. 02.00 hrs	Dt.17/07/2026 At 12.00 pm to Dt.06.08.2026 Upto.2.00 pm	Dt. 07. 08.2026 At. 02.00 pm

2. For detailed information, the interested bidders may visit the <https://mahatenders.gov.in>.

3. The Chief Executive Officer reserves the right to increase or decrease the quantity to be purchased and also reserves the right to cancel all the tenders without giving any reason to.

For e-tendering help/ information, please contact.
Website:- <https://mahatenders.gov.in>
Contact No:- 022-22621886 /022-22621973
Email:- maha.mmmpa2023@gmail.com

Signature
General Manager Technical
Maharashtra Medical Goods Procurement Authority, Mumbai

Dgipr/2026-27/1801

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ismale, S/o: Kambire, R/o: WZ-F-15D, Gali No. 06, Sant Garh, Tilak Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 691/2021, U/s: 14/14C, Police Station Tilak Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ismale** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ismale** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ismale of Police Station Tilak Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vikash Madan
JMFC, West, Room No. 289
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9581/WD/2026



Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Landmark, Race Course Circle, Vadodara- 390007
Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai- 400051
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Shil Tower Plot No-23, New Rohtak Road Karol Bagh New Delhi-110005
Notice for Disclosure of Legal Heirs of Deceased Borrower
PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice Is Hereby Given That Home Loan LBDEL00006125993 (Credit Facility) Was Granted To Deceased Sarla Singh & Ved Pal Singh By ICI Bank Ltd. (The Bank).

We Would Like To Inform You That The Demise of Sarla Singh & Ved Pal Singh Has Come To Our Knowledge During Field Visits Conducted By The Bank Officials And By Telephonic Communications on The Registered Contact Numbers. In This Regard, Letter Dated 15 July,2026 Was Previously Sent To The Registered Addresses of The Borrowers And The Deceased Sarla Singh & Ved Pal Singh, For Providing Information About The Legal Heirs of The Deceased Borrower.

Therefore, This Notice Is Hereby Given For Sharing Details of The Legal Heirs of The Deceased Sarla Singh & Ved Pal Singh With Supporting Documents For Updating The Bank's Records, Within 15 Days of Publication of This Notice.

You May Submit The Above-Mentioned Details To Mr. Neeraj Karan By Visiting Address: ICICI Bank Ltd Block C-1, 19th Floor World Trade Tower, Sector-16, Uttar Pradesh, Noida- 201301.

Date : July 18, 2026
Place : Delhi/Ncr

<SD> Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.



Regional Office: Netaji Marg, Nr. Mithakhali Six Roads, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-6. Phone: + 91-79-26421671-75

Demand Notice to Borrowers

The under mentioned account turned into N.P.A and demand notice is issued by Bandhan Bank Ltd. to the following borrower(s), under sec.13(2) of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act (The Act), 2002 which was returned unserved. Hence, this notice is issued to you all and public at large through publication.

Name of borrower(s) and Loan Account No.	Description of mortgaged property (Secured Asset)	Date of Demand Notice/Date of NPA	O/S Amount as on Date of Demand Notice	Date of Pasting of Notice
Mr. Sarfraz Mrs. Maksudan Mr. Kamruddin S/O Abdul Gafur 20003340000152	All That Piece Or Parcel Of Bearing Khasra No. 622, Admeasuring The Land Area As 86.68 Sq. Mtr. And The Super Built Up Area As 77.1 Sq. Mtr. Deed No. 6797 Dated 09.08.2017, Situated At Mohalla-Malik Nagar, Village-Sarna Muradnagar, Pargana-Jalalabad, Tehsil-Modinagar, Distt-Ghaziabad, State-Uttar Pradesh, Pin-201206. Owned By Mr. Kamruddin S/O Abdul Gafur, And Same Bonded As Under: North: Road 15 Ft. Wide, East: Plot Of Rizwan, West: Plot Of Manzur, South: Plot Of Israd	April 15, 2026/ April 05, 2026	Rs.13,63,614.91	July 10, 2026

Demand made against you through this notice to repay to the Bank dues mentioned against your name with interest, costs and charges within 60 days from the date hereof, failing which the Bank will further proceed to take steps u/s.13(4) of the SARFAESI Act. The borrowers /mortgagors' attention is invited to the provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Place: Ghaziabad
Date: July 18, 2026

Authorised Officer
Bandhan Bank Limited

HAMAS CONDEMNED STRIKE AS 'BRUTAL MASSACRE'

Israeli strike on funeral kills 7, wounds 22 people in Gaza

DEIR AL-BALAH: An Israeli strike on a funeral in the Gaza Strip has killed at least seven people and wounded another 22, according to a local hospital.

There was no immediate comment from the Israeli military.

The Awda Hospital in the Nuseirat refugee camp confirmed the number of casualties, saying people were struck at the funeral for a Palestinian killed in a strike earlier on Friday.

Hamas condemned the Nuseirat strike as a "brutal massacre" against mourners and urged mediators, as well as the United Nations, to act to halt Israeli attacks in Gaza.

On Thursday, Israeli airstrikes have killed at least a dozen people in Gaza over the past two days.

On Wednesday, three members of a family were killed in central Gaza, Al Aqsa Hospital officials said.

On Tuesday, a woman and six police officers were among those killed in an airstrike on a police station in the densely populated Jabaliya refugee camp in northern Gaza, hospital officials said.

A man died in the bombing of a tent camp in Khan Younis in the south, Nasser Hospital



Highlights

- » No immediate comment from the Israel side yet
- » On Thursday, Israeli airstrikes have killed a dozen people in Gaza over past two days
- » Israeli attacks on Gaza's police have been condemned by the UN rights office

officials said.

And Israeli forces shot and killed a child in the Muwasi area outside the southernmost city of Rafah, according to hospital officials.

The Israeli military did not immediately comment on the

strikes in central and southern Gaza. In a statement on the attack in Jabaliya, it claimed that four of the slain police officers were Hamas militants, without providing evidence on how those killed were involved in planning or carrying out

attacks.

One of the officers, Col. Mohamad Marwan Salem, was a senior police commander and head of the Jabaliya police station, the Hamas-run Interior Ministry said.

Hamas, which ruled Gaza for years, maintains an armed wing as well as civilian police and security services that are overseen by its Interior Ministry. Throughout the war, Israel has targeted local police, including those guarding humanitarian aid convoys.

Andy Burnham elected new Labour Party leader, British PM-designate

I have a plan, says Burnham with agenda for change in country



Andy Burnham

LONDON: For Andy Burnham, Friday proved a case of third time lucky as he was crowned the new leader of the Labour Party with a pledge to do politics differently after two failed attempts at the top job in 2010 and 2015. The 56-year-old prime minister-in-waiting will formally assume charge at Downing Street after a meeting with King Charles III at Buckingham Palace on Monday.

As someone who led a major delegation to India in 2019 in his previous avatar as Mayor of Greater Manchester, Burnham's commitment to growing the region's ties with India is expected to translate at the national level too.

"I have fond memories of my time in India in 2019, when I experienced first-hand so

Burnham returned to Westminster politics last month by winning a by-election at Makerfield in northern England

much of what this vibrant, welcoming country has to offer," said the former mayor during an Indian business delegation's visit to Manchester last year.

"That trip was significant because it saw us accelerate so many key projects, all aimed at capitalising on the strong synergies between Greater Manchester and India," he said.

Europe's early heat wave led to spike in deaths, may have killed over 10,000

The frequency and intensity of heat waves are supercharged by climate change, which comes from the burning of fuels

LONDON: Heat that hit Europe exceptionally early and hard this year appears to have led to a spike in deaths, with well over 10,000 more people dying at the height of the heat wave than would normally have been expected, according to figures that are still emerging across the continent.

Measures of what researchers call "excess mortality" — the difference between the normally expected number of deaths and the actual number — spiked in late June, when parts of Europe experienced record temperatures.

Experts caution that it takes a while for a full picture to emerge, and that many heat-related deaths will never formally be recorded as such.

For example, a heart attack, which can be triggered by extreme heat exposure, especially in people who are older or have underlying health issues, may be listed on a death certificate simply as a heart attack.

It's an alarming start to the



Representational Image

summer. Several heat waves have killed thousands of people in the past few years in Europe. Still, 2003 stands as the deadliest year in Europe for heat, with about 70,000 deaths.

The frequency and intensity of heat waves are supercharged by climate change, which comes from the burning of fuels like coal, oil and gas.

The EuroMOMO mortality monitoring hub, which receives data from two dozen countries, gave an estimate of 14,260 for excess mortality from all causes in the week ending June 28, more than

12,000 of those deaths being among people age 65 and older. That's out of a total 84,583 deaths that week. Figures in the preceding and following weeks were far lower.

Lasse Vestergaard of Denmark's Statens Serum Institut, which coordinates EuroMOMO, said that "we attribute this to the heat wave affecting quite a lot of countries in Europe, and we do that because there is no other obvious explanation that could explain such a high excess mortality happening at the moment."



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG-E-2026-168

Approx Cost : 53633209.80	Earnest Money : 1072700.00
----------------------------------	-----------------------------------

Description of work : Jhansi Division : Provision of Quick Watering Facilities for passenger trains at Banda.

Date of closing Tender : 07/08/2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 12 Months.

* Tender online can be submitted up to **15:00 hrs on 07.08.2026**. * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.irops.gov.in

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRNCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2)(ii) Cr.Pc. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Surkhasa Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Rajender Kumar kanojia S/o late Lala ram R/o CB-56C, janta Flates, Hari Nagar, New Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 196/2023 U/s 420 IPC** has been registered at **P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Rajender Kumar kanojia** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Rajender Kumar kanojia** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Rajender Kumar kanojia under FIR No. 196/2023 U/s 420 IPC** registered at **P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains,
JMFC-11 (West), Room No. 31,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/9739/WD/2026
(court notice)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

No. CEN-2026-27-06 Dated: 15.07.2026

The Dy. Chief Engineer/Const./North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to 15.00 hrs, on 10.08.2026. The details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No. : CEN-2026-27-06	Approx. cost of work (Rs.) : Rs 35.37 Cr. (approx.)
Name of Work : Construction NEW El Building, other service building, Tower wagon shed, platform, extension of FOB/ramp, staff quarters etc. Supply, transportation and leading of Ballast, Track linking works, Transportation of P. Way materials, AT & FB welding & other ancillary misc. works for Manikpur Station under the jurisdiction of Dy. CE/C/PRYJ in connection with MKP-IDGJ 3rd line project.	
Bid Security (Rs.) : Rs 7073300/-	Completion period : 15 Months
Tender Closing Date & Time : 10.08.2026 15:00 hrs.	
Date of Opening of tender : 10.08.2026 15:30 hrs.	
Type of tendering : Open (Two Packet System)	

Note: 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.irops.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs on the due date of tender opening i.e. **10.08.2026**. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. The Bid Security shall be deposited either in cash through e-payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a scheduled commercial bank of India or as mentioned in tender documents. The Bank Guarantee bond shall be as per format in favour of FA & CAO/CNCR/PRYJ as given in Tender Document and shall be valid for a period of 90 days beyond the bid validity period. 4. Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight way ignored and shall not be considered. 5. Joint Venture (JV)/Consortiums/MOUs shall be considered for the tender having cost more than 10 Cr. 6. Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 7. The tenderers shall submit a certificate as given in tender document in standard format for all items without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. 8. Each page of the copy of documents/certificates in support of credentials, submitted by the tenderer, shall be self-attested/digitally signed by the tenderer or authorized representative of the tendering firm. Self-attestation shall include signature, stamp and date (on each page). Only those documents which are declared explicitly by the tenderer as "documents supporting the claim qualifying the laid down eligibility criteria", will be considered for evaluation his/her tender. In case of any wrong information submitted by the tenderer, the contract will be terminated. Bid Security (BS), Performance Guarantee (PG) and Security Deposit (SD) of contract will be forfeited and agency will be banned for doing business on entire Indian Railways for two (02) years. 9. GST Act & rules issued from time to time by the Government authorities shall be applicable. 10. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 11. Tender online can be submitted up to 15.00 hrs. on 10.08.2026 and will be opened at 15.30 hrs. on same day. 163726 (C)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRNCR

Sensex soars 965 pts on buying in blue-chip RIL, bank & IT stocks

The rupee appreciates by 12 paise to settle at 96.30 against the US dollar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Market benchmark indices ended sharply higher on Friday, with the Sensex climbing 964.58 points and the Nifty reaching the 24,330 level, propelled by buying in blue-chip Reliance Industries, Limited (RIL) bank and IT stocks.

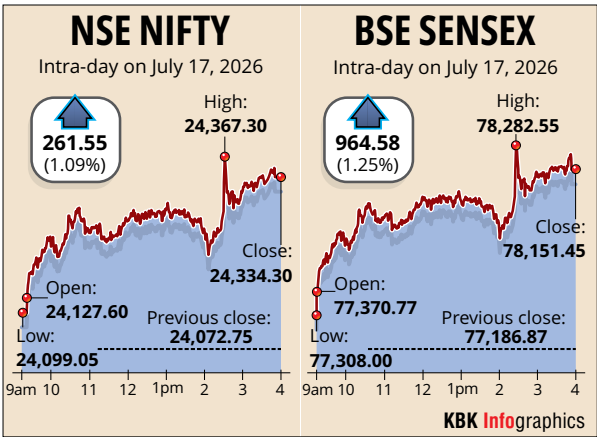
Additionally, a strengthening rupee against the US dollar improved sentiment, even as the broader market remained predominantly negative due to weak global cues, traders said.

After a subdued ending in the previous trade, the 30-share BSE Sensex bounced back 964.58 points, or 1.25 per cent, to settle at 78,151.45. During the day, it surged 1,095.68 points, or 1.41 per cent, to 78,282.55.

The 50-share NSE Nifty climbed 261.55 points, or 1.09 per cent, to end at 24,334.30.

“There is a shift in market momentum, with strong traction moving toward large-cap stocks, led by the IT and banking sectors. This is supported by optimism around business updates and Q1 earnings expectations,” Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Limited, said.

The trend appears to be driven largely by domestic institutional investors rotating out of expensive mid and



Among sectors, Pvt Banks Index climbed 1.81%, Top 10 Banks jumped 1.78%, MidSmall Pvt Banks Quality Tilt (1.65%), Bankex (1.58%), IT (1.38%), Focused IT(1.28%) and Financial Services (1.20%)

small-cap stocks and into more attractively valued large caps that offer a better risk-reward profile, he added.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark climbed 582.06 points, or 0.75 per cent, and the Nifty went up by 127.4 points, or 0.52 per cent.

From the Sensex pack, Tech Mahindra jumped 3.91 per cent after it reported a 28.4 per cent rise in consolidated net profit for the June quarter

to Rs 1,465 crore, and expressed confidence about the demand environment.

Kotak Mahindra Bank, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Reliance Industries, Hindustan Unilever, Mahindra & Mahindra, Axis Bank, ICICI Bank and Bajaj Finance were also among the winners.

Sun Pharma, Trent, Bharti Airtel and UltraTech Cement were among the laggards.

The BSE SmallCap Select

HIGHLIGHTS

» From the Sensex pack, Tech Mahindra jumped 3.91% after it reported a 28.4% rise in consolidated net profit for the June quarter to Rs 1,465 crore

» Kotak Mahindra Bank, Tata Consultancy Services, Reliance Industries, Hindustan Unilever, Mahindra & Mahindra, Axis Bank, ICICI Bank and Bajaj Finance were also among the winners

» BSE SmallCap Select index declined 0.32% and the MidCap Select index dipped 0.07%

index declined 0.32 per cent, and the MidCap Select index dipped 0.07 per cent.

Among sectors, Private Banks Index climbed 1.81 per cent, Top 10 Banks jumped 1.78 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt (1.65 per cent), Bankex (1.58 per cent), IT (1.38 per cent), Focused IT(1.28 per cent) and Financial Services (1.20 per cent).

Commodities, Industrials, Telecommunication and Metal

were the laggards.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, climbed 1.79 per cent to \$85.52 per barrel.

The rupee appreciated 12 paise to settle at 96.30 against the US dollar on Friday.

“Indian equity markets ended the week on a strong note, extending their recovery as broad-based buying in heavyweight banking, financial, and IT stocks helped benchmark indices outperform weak global cues. Investor sentiment remained resilient despite persistent concerns over elevated AI valuations, ongoing geopolitical tensions in the Middle East, and heightened volatility in global markets,” Ponmudi R, CEO of Enrich Money, an online trading and wealth tech firm, said.

Expectations of healthy quarterly earnings from index heavyweights, including Reliance Industries and leading private sector banks, further supported the positive momentum, he added.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 4,205.56 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

On Thursday, the Sensex edged up 1.44 points to settle at 77,186.87. The Nifty dipped 5.75 points, or 0.02 per cent, to end at 24,072.75.

AI to fuel India’s technology services growth, says report

‘End-user spending on public cloud services projected to surge 28.1 per cent year-on-year to \$17.5 billion’

NEW DELHI: India’s technology services sector is expected to see strong AI-led growth, with end-user spending on public cloud services projected to surge 28.1 per cent year-on-year to \$17.5 billion, according to Equirus Securities.

Globally, the AI boom is driving a rapid expansion of colocation data centres, with demand projected to nearly triple from around 82 GW in 2025 to about 220 GW by 2030, as per Equirus. Furthermore, “AI workloads are projected to account for around 70 per cent of total data center demand by 2030, making access to power, advanced chips, and fast project execution the key competitive differentiators,” it said.

For India, these factors are creating a positive outlook, as private equity firms are increasingly encouraging their portfolio companies to establish Global Capability Centres, which is expanding the GCC landscape beyond large multinational corporations.

Furthermore, these captive centres are being set up to strengthen capabilities in AI, engineering, product development, finance and analytics, while enhancing operational efficiency and accelerating value creation. The report noted that India’s vast talent pool, cost competitiveness and strong digital capabilities



‘Globally, AI boom is driving a rapid expansion of colocation data centres, with demand projected to triple to about 220 GW by 2030’

are driving this trend, with PE-backed and mid-sized companies emerging as key contributors to the country’s expanding GCC ecosystem.

AI services market, on the other hand, is already gaining traction, “generating an estimated \$10-12 billion in revenue, with nearly 25 per cent of enterprises moving AI initiatives from pilot projects to production,” the report noted.

Equirus estimates that India’s technology services sector is well-positioned to benefit from growing demand for enterprise modernization, data engineering, AI governance and intelligent opera-

KEY POINTS

- » ‘AI workloads are projected to account for around 70 per cent of total data center demand by 2030’
- » India’s vast talent pool, cost competitiveness and strong digital capabilities are driving this trend
- » AI services market, on the other hand, is already gaining traction, ‘generating an estimated \$10-12 billion in revenue’

tions, backed by the country’s large AI-skilled workforce and deep enterprise expertise.

Furthermore, public cloud spending in India is projected to grow 28.1 per cent year-on-year in FY26, with Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS) and Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) are expected to lead the growth as organizations expand cloud-native and AI workloads.

“The end-user spending on public cloud services in India is projected to grow 28.1 per cent YoY to \$17.5 billion in 2026, up from \$13.7 billion in 2025, driven by accelerating enterprise cloud adoption,” the report noted.

Reserve Bank’s currency printing arm invites global bids for polymer banknote substrate

MUMBAI: Bharatiya Reserve Bank Note Mudran Private Limited (BRBNMPL), the currency-printing subsidiary of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), has floated a Global Expression of Interest (EOI) inviting manufacturers worldwide to supply opacified polymer substrate sheets embedded with security features for printing Indian banknotes.

The EOI, released on Friday, seeks an indicative quantity of 68,000 reams of BOPP (Biaxially Oriented Polypropylene)-based polymer substrate, 34,000 reams each for two denominations, with each ream comprising 500 sheets.

The material must carry security features such as a clear window with portrait, metallic numeral, magnetic pseudo thread, shadow image and iri-



Sources in the know say that the polymer notes are likely to be in the lower denominations of Rs 10 and 20 in the starting phase

descent pattern, suitable for printing at BRBNMPL and SPMCIL presses.

Sources in the know say that

the polymer notes are likely to be in the lower denominations of Rs 10 and 20 in the starting phase. The ink used to print the notes is also specially made based on security requirements.

Notably, the EOI carries strict national-security riders: bidders must ensure their operations in China or Pakistan are firewalled from any India-linked business, must not source raw material from either country, and must not engage personnel who have worked in China or Pakistan in any capacity.

Entities from countries sharing a land border with India must be registered with the DPIIT’s Registration Committee to be eligible. BRBNMPL said the current requirement is only an immediate one, and a larger procurement across multiple

denominations is likely to follow in subsequent tenders once field trials of the substrate prove successful.

Bidders, domestic or global, including technology collaborators, joint venture partners or subsidiaries, must have at least three years’ experience supplying polymer substrate with security features to a central bank or banknote/security printing organisation, and must offer a minimum of 20,400 reams (30 per cent of the indicative quantity) to qualify.

Applicants are also required to submit at least 10 sample polymer sheets for laboratory testing, certified free of animal tallow or DNA content, along with proof of financial net worth, manufacturing capacity and security clearance eligibility.

Plea in SC seeks CBI probe into Reliance’s alleged gas extraction

NEW DELHI: A petition has been filed in the Supreme Court seeking a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into the alleged unauthorised extraction of natural gas by Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) from an ONGC-operated block in the Krishna-Godavari (KG) Basin.

The appeal, filed by Jitendra Punamchand Maru, challenges a March 27 judgment of the Bombay High Court that dismissed his plea as an abuse of the judicial process. Maru has sought directions for registration of an FIR against RIL, its directors and others on charges including alleged theft, criminal breach of trust, dishonest misappropriation and criminal conspiracy.

The dispute relates to the alleged migration of gas from

ONGC’s KG Basin blocks to the adjoining KG-D6 block operated by RIL and its consortium partners. Maru alleged that RIL extracted gas from ONGC’s fields through sideways drilling, relying on reports examining gas migration and subsequent court proceedings involving RIL and the Union government.

He contended that despite findings regarding the alleged extraction of gas from the adjoining ONGC block, no criminal investigation was initiated.

After the CBI closed his complaint in September 2025, he approached the High Court, which dismissed the petition.

The CBI argued before the High Court that the matter was prima facie a civil dispute and noted that neither ONGC nor

the Union government had sought a criminal investigation.

RIL denied the allegations, calling the petition an attempt to damage its reputation and gain publicity.

The High Court also questioned Maru’s delay of more than a decade in pursuing criminal proceedings and observed that initiating a criminal case carries serious consequences for those accused.

The commercial dispute over the alleged gas migration has already been the subject of arbitration. An arbitral tribunal ruled in RIL’s favour in 2018. While a single judge of the Delhi High Court upheld the award in 2023, a Division Bench set it aside in February 2025. RIL’s appeal against that ruling is pending before the Supreme Court.

Ladakh L-G commissions India’s 1st geothermal wells at Puga Valley

LEH: India on Friday commissioned its first and deepest geothermal wells at Puga Valley in Ladakh, marking a major step towards establishing the country’s first geothermal power plant.

Lieutenant Governor V K Saxena inaugurated the two 1,000-metre-deep wells, developed by ONGC Energy Centre at an altitude of over 14,000 feet.

The wells will support the 1 MW pilot geothermal power project, India’s first demonstration-scale geothermal power project, and advance Ladakh’s goal of becoming a carbon-neutral clean energy hub.

The project had faced delays after the expiry of the tripartite memorandum of under-



standing between the Ladakh Administration, LAHDC Leh and ONGC Energy Centre.

The pact was renewed for five years in June following the Lieutenant Governor’s intervention, allowing work to resume.

The completed wells will enable reservoir evaluation,

power plant planning and future commercial development of geothermal resources.

Engineers have recorded temperatures of up to 135 degrees Celsius at a depth of 400 metres and are continuing tests in the hope of finding higher temperatures needed for power generation.

Consumer Online Foundation urges PMO to set up National Task Force on illicit tobacco trade

NEW DELHI: Consumer Online Foundation (COF) has urged the Prime Minister’s Office to constitute a National Task Force on Illicit Tobacco Trade under the Cabinet Secretariat or the PMO to combat the growing market for smuggled cigarettes, counterfeit tobacco products and illegal nicotine products.

In a representation to the Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister, the Foundation said India’s tobacco control efforts through legislation and taxation are being undermined by illicit products that evade taxes, regulatory oversight and mandatory health safeguards.

COF said the illegal trade deprives the government of

GST, customs duty and other revenues while exposing consumers to products that bypass health warnings, quality standards and age restrictions. It also warned that illicit tobacco trade fuels organised crime, facilitates cross-border smuggling and weakens the country’s tobacco control framework.

The Foundation proposed a high-level task force comprising representatives from the ministries of Health, Finance, Home Affairs, Consumer Affairs and Commerce, along with agencies such as the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence, the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs and state enforcement authorities. The body would prepare a National Anti-Illicit

Tobacco Strategy aimed at curbing smuggling and counterfeit manufacturing, strengthening intelligence-led enforcement, improving tax compliance and protecting consumers.

COF also recommended a 100-day action agenda that includes stronger border surveillance, coordinated enforcement against counterfeit manufacturing, enhanced market inspections, a national consumer reporting mechanism, a data repository for evidence-based policymaking, public awareness campaigns and annual performance reviews.

Consumer policy expert and COF founder Prof. Bejon Kumar Misra said taxation alone cannot deliver pub-

lic health objectives if illicit tobacco products continue to flourish. He said international experience shows consumers often shift to cheaper illegal products rather than reducing consumption when the price gap widens.

A coordinated national strategy involving all relevant ministries and enforcement agencies is essential to tackle the challenge, he added.

The Foundation cited recent policy discussions in Australia, where lawmakers examined how illicit tobacco markets have expanded alongside rising price differentials, arguing that India should similarly combine fiscal measures with stronger enforcement against illegal trade.

CCPA slaps ₹1L fine on SpiceJet for using ‘dark patterns’

An inquiry found customers were auto-enrolled in SpiceClub through a pre-ticked checkbox

NEW DELHI: The Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) has imposed a penalty of Rs 1 lakh on SpiceJet for using deceptive design practices, or “dark patterns”, on its flight booking platform that automatically enrolled users into its loyalty programme and opted them in for promotional messages.

The order followed an inquiry led by Chief Commissioner Nidhi Khare and Commissioner Anupam Mishra, which found that customers were enrolled in the SpiceClub Loyalty Programme through a pre-ticked checkbox. Users



were also deemed to have consented to receive promotional messages because the opt-in option was selected by default.

The CCPA said that even after receiving a notice, SpiceJet replaced one pre-ticked checkbox with another for promotional communication via SMS, WhatsApp and email, effectively continuing the same

CLOSER LOOK

- » CCPA noted that even after it issued a notice, SpiceJet merely swapped one pre-ticked checkbox for another
- » This time for promotional messages via SMS, WhatsApp, email, effectively continuing the practice in different form

practice. During the proceedings, SpiceJet attributed the issue to a technical error. The airline has been directed to submit an undertaking confirming that corrective measures have been implemented and will remain in place.

The authority identified three dark patterns on the plat-

form: “forced action” through automatic enrolment into the loyalty programme, “interface interference” by presenting the company’s preferred option as the default choice, and a “trick question” involving confusing consent language.

CCPA held that these practices violated provisions of the Consumer Protection

Act, 2019, relating to unfair trade practices, unfair contract terms and misleading representations.

It also found the airline in breach of the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020, and the Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023.

The authority said consent obtained through pre-ticked boxes, default settings or deceptive interface design does not qualify as valid consent under the law and reaffirmed its commitment to ensuring fair and transparent digital business practices.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



REC Limited has signed a Memorandum of Agreement (MoA) with Career Forum for the implementation of a CSR project titled ‘Establishment of 20 Smart Classrooms in Government Schools of Alipurduar, West Bengal.’ The MoA was signed on July 14, 2026 by Arun Kumar Tyagi, Executive Director (CSR), REC Limited & Anant Chauhan, Chairman, Career Forum, in the presence of L B Nautiyal, HoD (CSR), REC Limited.



PNB signed an MoU with Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD) at its Corporate Office in Dwarka, New Delhi. The MoU was formalized in presence of M Paramasivam, Executive Director, PNB; Amitabh Nag, CEO, DIBD & Atish Kumar Rout, Chief General Manager (D) Digital Banking Transformation Division, PNB. Through this partnership, BHASHINI’s advanced multilingual AI capabilities will be integrated into PNB’s digital platforms.

Reliance Industries posts record core profit & EBITDA for Q1 FY27

Company’s EBITDA climbed 10.1 per cent to a record Rs 54,067 crore, while profit after tax rose 6.1 per cent to a record Rs 23,196 crore

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Reliance Industries Ltd, India’s most valuable company, reported record quarterly core profit and EBITDA for the June quarter, powered by strong performances across its oil-to-chemicals and telecom businesses.

Its consolidated revenue rose 25.4 per cent year-on-year to Rs 3.12 lakh crore, the oil-to-telecom conglomerate said in a statement.

On a recurring basis - stripping out a one-off Rs 8,924 crore gain from the sale of listed investments in the year-ago quarter - EBITDA climbed 10.1 per cent to a record Rs 54,067 crore, while profit after tax rose 6.1 per cent to a record Rs 23,196 crore.

Including that one-time gain in the year-ago base, however, EBITDA was down 6.8 per cent, and profit attributable to owners of the company fell 22 per cent year-on-year to Rs 20,946 crore, underscoring how last year’s exceptional item flattened the comparison, even as underlying operations strengthened.

The resilient earnings came in a quarter marred by elevated crude prices following the Iran war. The supply-chain disruption



Its consolidated revenue rose 25.4% year-on-year to Rs 3.12 lakh crore, the company said in a statement

tions that followed the war led the company to raise LPG production by diverting streams it otherwise used to produce value-added petrochemicals.

Core earnings in the oil-to-chemicals business, which includes its twin refining assets and petrochemical plants, rose 17.2 per cent from a year earlier.

Telecom business continued to be a key driver, reporting a core earnings growth of 15.1 per cent, a 533-million strong subscriber base and expanding revenues from technology investments.

Retail business, however,

HIGHLIGHTS

» Jio Platforms posted EBITDA of Rs 20,865 crore, up 15.1% y-o-y, with margins expanding 150 bps to 53.3%

» Reliance Retail posted revenue rose 7.4% to Rs 90,408 crore, but EBITDA slipped 1.1% to Rs 6,309 crore

» Oil-to-chemicals (O2C) business delivered EBITDA growth of 17.2% to Rs 17,010 cr

was muted due to continued investment in digital commerce platforms.

Profits in April-June - the first quarter of 2026-27 fiscal - were also impacted by higher finance costs and depreciation, following the capitalisation of 5G assets.

Jio Platforms Ltd (JPL) reported record EBITDA of Rs 20,865 crore, up 15.1 per cent year-on-year, with margins expanding 150 basis points to 53.3 per cent. The unit’s subscriber base topped 533 million, including 285 million on Jio’s True5G network.

In the quarter’s biggest corporate milestone, Jio Platforms filed its draft red herring prospectus with India’s markets regulator Sebi, formally kicking off the process toward what is expected to be one of the country’s largest-ever public listings.

Chairman Mukesh Ambani said Jio’s mobility, home broadband and enterprise businesses “remained strong, driving healthy earnings growth of 15 per cent Y-o-Y”, and called the DRHP filing “a significant step towards its public listing” that would “give investors an opportunity to participate in India’s digital growth story”.

The oil-to-chemicals (O2C) business delivered EBITDA growth of 17.2 per cent to Rs 17,010 crore, aided by what Reliance described as all-time high middle distillate cracks and improved downstream petrochemical margins, even as the unit contended with costlier feedstock and a planned maintenance turnaround.

Reliance Retail (RRVL) posted more muted results: revenue rose 7.4 per cent to Rs 90,408 crore, but EBITDA slipped 1.1 per cent to Rs 6,309 crore, with margin contracting 80 basis points to 7.9 per cent - a moderation the company attributed to continued investment in its digital commerce

platforms.

Reliance’s consumer packaged goods arm, RCPL, more than doubled revenue from a year earlier.

The oil and gas segment posted 3.2 per cent revenue growth on higher KG-D6 realisations, with EBITDA broadly stable year-on-year.

Capital expenditure for the quarter stood at Rs 38,682 crore, with the company citing continued investment in O2C expansion and new energy projects, alongside its consumer business infrastructure.

Net debt stood at Rs 1,22,914 crore, with net debt-to-EBITDA at a conservative 0.57 times.

“Reliance has made a steady start to FY27, with all businesses delivering strong operating performance”, Ambani said, adding that the portfolio had “once again demonstrated its resilience in a quarter which witnessed continuing geopolitical tensions and volatile commodity markets”.

He said the quarter left him “confident in the underlying strength of our businesses” and “reason to be optimistic about the year ahead” as the company moves toward new energy project commissioning and the Jio listing.

Amfi streamlines MF transmission process, eases claims for nominees

Revised standard operating procedure seeks to reduce documentation-related hurdles in transmission process

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Association of Mutual Funds in India (Amfi) on Friday simplified the process for transmission of mutual fund units following the death of an investor, after a directive from Sebi aimed at making claims easier for nominees and legal heirs.

The revised standard operating procedure (SOP), which takes immediate effect, seeks to reduce documentation-related hurdles during the transmission process by addressing common issues such as mismatches in the deceased investor’s address, name and signature.

According to the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi), as part of its ongoing investor-friendly initiatives, it advised Amfi to further simplify the standards governing the “Procedure to Claim Units/Proceeds upon death of a unit holder” to address operational challenges faced by the families of deceased investors. Amfi has accordingly amended the industry standards.

In a statement, the regulator said the changes are intended to facilitate ease of transmission while aligning industry practices with its objective of safeguarding investor interests.

Under the revised framework, Asset Management Companies (AMCs) may rely on the latest available address



Amfi said the revised SOP was aimed at reducing operational hurdles and enabling nominees of deceased unit holders to claim mutual fund units or proceeds more smoothly

of the deceased unit holder, provided it is supported by relevant documents, in cases where the address recorded in mutual fund records differs from the address submitted by the claimant.

The move is expected to reduce delays arising from address discrepancies.

Sebi has also introduced a harmonised framework for resolving name and signature mismatches. AMCs may now adopt procedures similar to

those prescribed for Registrars to an Issue and Share Transfer Agents (RTAs).

Under these guidelines, claimants can submit self-certified identity documents such as Aadhaar or Passport to resolve name mismatches. For signature discrepancies, AMCs may follow appropriate procedures depending on the nature of the mismatch, in line with the RTA framework.

In a separate statement, Amfi said the revised SOP was aimed at reducing operational hurdles and enabling nominees of deceased unit holders to claim mutual fund units or proceeds more smoothly.

The industry body noted that the changes come amid concerns over the difficulties faced by nominees and legal heirs in completing transmission formalities because of minor documentation inconsistencies.

“The updated SOP guidelines have been communicated to all member AMCs and take effect immediately”, Amfi said. To ensure consistent implementation across the mutual fund industry, Sebi has advised Amfi to conduct training for all relevant entities involved in the transmission process.

Amfi said it will facilitate training initiatives through member AMCs to promote uniform application of the revised procedures and adherence to regulatory guidelines.

Reliance promoters increase stake by 0.5%

NEW DELHI: The promoter group of Reliance Industries Ltd increased shareholding by nearly 0.5 percentage points during the June quarter through market purchases, reinforcing its long-term commitment to the country’s most valuable company.

Regulatory shareholding data showed the promoter and promoter group raised their

stake to 50.48 per cent at the end of the June quarter from about 50 per cent three months earlier.

The purchases were made within the limits permitted under the Sebi’s creeping acquisition regulations, which allow promoters to gradually increase ownership without triggering a mandatory open offer, subject to prescribed thresholds.

Market analysts believe market purchases by the promoter group would have cost Rs 8,500-9,000 crore.

Reliance Chairman Mukesh Ambani, his wife and three children — Isha, Akash and Anant — hold 1.61 crore shares, or 0.12 per cent stake, each in Reliance, according to the latest shareholding filing by the company. His mother

K D Ambani holds 3.14 crore shares, or 0.24 per cent, in Reliance.

Rest of the shares are held through promoter group entities with Srichakra Commercials LLP holding the largest at 10.93 per cent. Devvarshi Commercials LLP, Karuna Commercial LLP, and Tattvam Enterprises LLP hold 8.06 per cent stake each. PTI

NEW DELHI: The government on Friday said it has included iron ore in the list of core sector infrastructure industries, a move which will help in capturing the performance of the economy in a better way.

Currently, the government

evaluates the performance of eight key sectors — crude oil, petroleum refinery, cement, electricity, natural gas, fertiliser, finished steel and coal — on a monthly basis.

“In view of the extensive use of iron ore in industrial production and its significant contribution to industrial development, Iron Ore has been included as a core

industry in the revised Index of Core Industries series,” the Commerce and Industry Ministry said in a statement.

The new series with base year 2022-23, containing data for nine key sectors, will be released on July 20 this year.

The revised series will replace the existing Index of Core Industries (ICI) series with the base year 2011-12.

The ministry also said that to ensure consistency with the IIP (Index of Industrial Production), the revised ICI series uses gross production data for compiling the Steel Index, replacing the net production data used in the ICI (2011-12) series.

In the coal sector also, only Raw Coal has been retained in the revised series. PTI

Sport

A PARTING GIFT

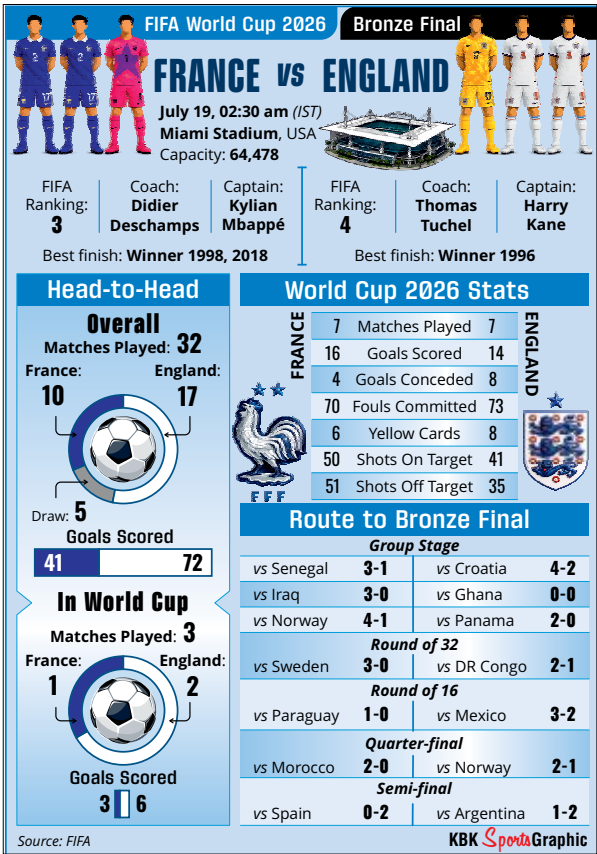
Deschamps’ last dance, Mbappe’s record chase give third-place game an edge

MIAMI: France and England will have to pick themselves up from crushing World Cup semi-final defeats for Saturday’s third-place game, with Didier Deschamps taking charge of Les Bleus for the final time and Kylian Mbappe chasing individual history in a game likely to feature sweeping changes on both sides.

France’s hopes of reaching a third successive World Cup final were emphatically ended by Spain in a 2-0 defeat on Tuesday, while England suffered their own heartbreak a day later with a 2-1 loss to Argentina. The Miami match will bring down the curtain on Deschamps’ 14-year reign, during which he led France to the 2018 World Cup title, the final four years later and three successive World Cup semi-finals.

While the 57-year-old had hoped to leave with a second world title as a coach, Saturday offers his players one last opportunity to send off the man who established France as one of international football’s most consistent forces over the past decade.

With both teams physically and emotionally drained after deep runs through the expanded 48-team tournament, however, the traditional bronze-medal match may feel



like an unwanted assignment for players who arrived in North America dreaming of lifting the trophy. “None of these players,

none of the French players want to play this match. They want to play in the final. We gave everything to be in the final,” England coach Thomas



This will be France’s fourth third-place play-off at a World Cup, and their first since 1986

Tuchel said.

France are expected to rotate their starting lineup significantly, giving opportunities to players who have featured less during the tournament, while Tuchel could take a similar approach after his side’s exhausting campaign.

There could, however, be one compelling reason for France captain Mbappe to start. The 27-year-old has scored eight goals at this World Cup and 20 overall, leaving him in contention for the Golden Boot and within reach of the tournament’s all-time scoring record.

With little collective pressure attached to the third-place playoff, the match could offer Mbappe a final opportunity to turn a disappointing end to France’s campaign into another landmark moment in a career already defined by the World Cup. England will have their own disappointment to overcome after coming agonisingly close to Sunday’s final, and Tuchel may also use the game to give minutes to those who have spent much of the tournament on the sidelines. AGENCIES

‘Nothing was handed to us’: Messi fires back at critics

ATLANTA: Lionel Messi has a message for Argentina’s detractors: “Nothing was handed to us.”

The Argentina superstar responded to critics who have been bashing the reigning World Cup champions over perceptions of beneficial officiating and favoritism by the soccer establishment. He said the team’s ability to overturn late-game deficits, most recently the semifinal victory over England, is the result of championship pedigree and nothing more.

After trailing 1-0 going into the 85th minute, Argentina rallied for a 2-1 win over England on Wednesday to reach the World Cup final.

The victory led tens of thousands to flood the streets of Buenos Aires in ecstatic celebrations, and marked another remarkable comeback that

showed the perseverance of a team that is now one win from a back-to-back titles. Argentina faces Spain in Sunday’s final.

Argentina earlier survived by beating Cape Verde and Switzerland in extra time, and rallied for an improbable 3-2 victory over Egypt after coming back from being down 2-0 with 11 minutes of regulation time to play. But both the Swiss and Egyptian coaches criticized the refereeing. Egypt’s Hossam Hassan went as far as to say that his team was the victim of a soccer establishment that favored Messi and Argentina. “We’ve been the best over these past four years, either you like it or not, and no matter what anyone says,” Messi said after the win over England. “Once again, we’ve established ourselves among the top two teams in the world.” AGENCIES

India unable to solve Root problem as Eng pull level



Joe Root made an unbeaten 99

CARDIFF: A steadfast Joe Root anchored England’s series-levelling four-wicket win over India in the second ODI here after the visitors’ batting once again seemed vulnerable with senior player Rohit Sharma’s struggles triggering fresh speculation around his future.

Root delivered an unbeaten 99 off 133 balls to steer England home and keep them alive in the three-match series that will conclude at the Lord’s on Sunday. That game could well be Rohit’s final in India colours after he struggled to a 47-ball 26, adding to the pressure on him. He looked out of touch as India were dismissed for 233 in 44 overs on Thursday. Virat Kohli (65) and Shreyas Iyer (66) ensured that the bowlers had something to fight with after other batters disappointed. AGENCIES



20-year-old Lionel Messi with Lamine Yamal during the photo session

From bath time to big time, life comes full circle for Yamal and Messi

BARCELONA: Almost two decades ago, photographer Joan Monfort didn’t think much of his photo shoot of a teenage Lionel Messi bathing a cute baby boy in a plastic bathtub. Not until the remarkable twist of fate became clear years later, when that infant blossomed into Lamine Yamal.

Now those images of the longhaired Messi, his hands covered in soap suds as if anointing Yamal as soccer’s

Next Big Thing, have become the most talked about — and gawked about — in the runup to Sunday’s World Cup final, when Messi’s Argentina will play Yamal’s Spain for the biggest trophy in the sport.

“I have never been a believer or thought that anything was destined to occur, but I am beginning to have my doubts. This is beyond all reasonable explanations,” Monfort told The Associated Press

from his home in Barcelona on Friday. Monfort, who works as a freelance photojournalist for the AP, took the photos in 2007 as part of a charity calendar produced by local newspaper Sport and UNICEF.

Luck dictated that Yamal’s mother, who appears in the calendar photo, won a raffle of families in the city of Mataró, near Barcelona, who wanted to participate. Soccer destiny then deemed that her baby boy, who

would become a star for Barcelona some 15 years later, was paired up with the Argentine who would become the greatest of all time.

A tearful Messi left Barcelona in 2021 when the club was in financial trouble. Yamal erupted at the club two years later. The journey is now complete, from bathtub to World Cup final, when the 19-year-old Yamal will face a Messi who is 20 years his senior.

Monfort had no recollection of the photos until Yamal’s father posted one on social media during the 2024 European Championship, when a teenage Yamal was enjoying his international breakout and led Spain to the title.

The photo went viral then. But now with the World Cup final looming, Monfort said, interest in his photos has skyrocketed. “This has exploded all over the world, and the fact

that the final is in the U.S. has given it the extra push,” Monfort said. “And now this has culminated with the final between Messi and Yamal. It is better than any film script.”

Monfort said that he has been bombarded by queries for the photos by professional media outlets, while also seeing his images reproduced countless times on social media and the internet without any credit or compensation. AGENCIES

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender No.: CEN-2026-27-07Date: 15.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

The Dy. Chief Engineer/Const./North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to **15:00 hrs. on 10.08.2026**. The details of the tenders are as under:-

Name of work: Construction of 12 M wide FOB at Banda in c/w KID-MKP doubling under the jurisdiction of Dy. CE/C/PRYJ/NCR.

Approx. cost of work (Rs.): 21.25 Cr. (approx.) | **Bid Security (Rs.):** 42.49,300.00

Completion Period: 12 Months, **Tender Closing Date & Time:** 10.08.2026, 15:00 hrs., **Date of Opening of tender:** 10.08.2026, 15:30 hrs., **Type of tendering:** Open (Two Packet System). **Note:-** 1. The Complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website **www.irops.gov.in** up to **15:00 hrs.** on the due date of tender opening i.e. **10.08.2026**. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with **IREPS** website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. The Bid Security shall be deposited either in cash through e-payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a scheduled commercial bank of India or as mentioned in tender documents. The Bank Guarantee bond shall be as per **format in favour of FA & CAO/C/NCR/PRYJ** as given in Tender Document and shall be valid for a period of **90 days beyond the bid validity period**. 4. Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight way ignored and shall not be considered. 5. Joint Venture (JV)/Consortiums/MOUs shall be considered for the tender having cost more than 10 Cr. 6. Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 7. The tenderers shall submit a certificate as given in tender document in standard format for all items without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. 8. Each page of the copy of documents/certificates in support of credentials, submitted by the tenderer, shall be self-attested/digitally signed by the tenderer or authorized representative of the tendering firm. Self-attestation shall include signature, stamp and date (on each page). Only those documents which are declared explicitly by the tenderer as "documents supporting the claim qualifying the laid down eligibility criteria", will be considered for evaluation his/her tender. In case of any wrong information submitted by the tenderer, the contract will be terminated, Bid Security (BS), Performance Guarantee (PG and Security Deposit (SD) of contract will be forfeited and agency will be banned for doing business on entire Indian Railways for two (2) years. 9. GST Act & rules issued from time to time by the Government authorities shall be applicable. 10. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of **IREPS** may be approached. 11. Tender online can be submitted up to **15:00 hrs.** on **10.08.2026** and will be opened at 15:30 hrs. on same day. **163826 (D)**

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

**CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER TRANSMISSION CO. LTD**
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking) (A Successor Company of CSEB)

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (PROJECT),
Address : Third floor, SLDC Building, Dangania Raipur-492013. GST No.22AADCC5773E1ZX
Website : www.cspc.co.in Phone 0771-2574238/4245/4209 Fax:0771-2574246

No.02-04/NIT/TL/TR-25/12/889Raipur/dtd. 16/07/2026

E-NOTICE INVITING TENDER (E-Bidding)

(Tender No. TR-25/12)

Sealed tenders are invited from experienced Bidders for taking up the following Project on turnkey basis in Chhattisgarh State:-

Tender No.	Particulars	Cost of Tender Documents (Non-refundable)	Earnest money (Rs.)	Due date of opening
TR-25/12 RFX. No. 8100053083	Construction of LILO of existing 400 KV Korba(W)-Khedamara (at present Dhardehi) and 400 KV Korba(W)-Madwa lines from existing location No. 04 & 05 to proposed GIS Substation of 2x660 MW Power Plant Korba of CSPGCL under Transmission scheme (Total RL-3 Km.)	Rs.10,000/- (Including 18% GST)	Rs.5.00 Lac	21/08/2026 15.30 Hrs.

Note: For more details, Tender schedule & Tender Documents visit our website: <http://www.cspc.co.in> > e bidding > e bidding web portal (OR) <https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in:50724/irj/portal>

Chief Engineer (Project),
SAVE ELECTRICITY samvad 48483/5 **CSPCTL, Raipur**

**UJVN Limited**
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No.U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website-www.ujvnll.com

पत्र सं० 585दिनांक: 17 / 07 / 2026

E-Tender TIME EXTENSION NOTICE & CORRIGENDUM

Estimated Cost, Earnest Money & Tender Fees of e-Tender No - 05/EE (E&M)/MB-II/Barrage/2026-27 invited by the office of the Executive Engineer (E&M), MB-II, Joshiyara Barrage, Uttarkashi Shall be read as follows and the Date of submission and opening of the tender is hereby extended as follows.

Estimated Cost : ₹8,35,800.00 (Rupees Eight Lakhs Thirty-Five Thousand and Eight Hundred Only + GST Extra (In place of ₹10,25,800.00 (Rupees Ten Lakhs Twenty-Five Thousand Eight Hundred only) + GST extra.

Earnest Money : Rs 25,100.00 Only (In place of Rs 32,780.00 (including taxes) mentioned at page no 8 of tender Document)

Tender Fees: Rs 590.00 only (Including Taxes) (In place of Rs 1180.00 (including taxes) mentioned at page no 8 of tender Document)

Last date for submission of bids on website:- 28.07.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.

Last date of submitting hard copy of documents in the office of Executive Engineer (E&M), MB-II, Joshiyara Barrage, Uttarkashi : 29.07.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs

Due date for opening the tender on website - 31.07.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer (E&M)
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BN55)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Abhishek S/o Lt. Parveen Kumar R/o H. No. 410, Karan Vihar Part-2, Kidadi, Suleman Nagar, Nangloi, Outer District, Delhi, Aman Vihar, Delhi-86** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 419/2023 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Abhishek** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Abhishek** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Abhishek in FIR No. 419/2023 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS GTB Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.08.2026**.

By order
Ms. Sanghmitra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Room No. 54, Second Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/9792/SHD/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

Ref: Tender Notice No. 21/2026-2027 dated 19.06.2026 S. No. 03 Tender No. 77269045RGC Opening date 21.07.2026.

In reference to above, tender opening date has been extended from 21.07.2026 to 21.08.2026. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

The Corrigendum has been published on website **www.irops.gov.in**.

Note: This is the First Corrigendum in above referred tender.

Date: 16.07.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2472/26

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Letter No:- DRM/CI/AGRA/NFRE-AUCTIONDated:- 16.07.2026

E - Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per category given as under :-

Category: Misc-Mobile-Services	Catalogue No. : 20176-PUB-26-01
--------------------------------	---------------------------------

Asset Details

Allotment of advertisement rights through provision of advertisement patches on the front & back of food trays and headrest covers at each seat in all the coaches of Vande Bharat express (Train no. 20175/76).

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date: 31.07.2026 Time 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time: 31.07.2026 Time 11:30

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.irops.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **1635/26(AK)**

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Letter No.: DRMC/AGRA/Parcel/E-AuctionDated: 15.07.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-AUCTION

On Behalf of The President of India, The Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, North Central Railway, Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: Parcel	Auction Catalogue No.: AGRA-LEASING-50
------------------	--

Asset Details:-(1) 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 19818- Sunday, Thursday & Friday

(2) 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 13168

(3) 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 19818- Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Saturday

(4) 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 12195- Tuesday, Thursday & Saturday

(5) 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 59814

(6) 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 20178

(7) 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 12180

(8) 01 round trip VP Unit in Train No. 15110-15109

E-Auction Start Date and Time: 04.08.2026 at 13.30 hrs.

E-Auction End Date and Time: 04.08.2026 at 15.10 hrs.

Note:- Prospective bidder are requested to visit **e-Auction Leasing module** on **IREPS** website (www.irops.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **1625/26 (A)**

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Form No. INC-26
[Pursuant to Rule 30 of Companies (Incorporation) Rules 2014]

Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the Company from one state to another

Before the Central Government (Regional Director)
Northern Region, Delhi

In the matter of sub-section (4) of section 13 of the Companies Act 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of Rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules 2014
AND

In the matter of M/S COLORZ N STYLE PRIVATE LIMITED ("Company") having its Registered Office at H.NO 4794, GALI NO. 45/46 REGHARPURA, KAROL BAGH, CENTRAL DELHI, NEW DELHI, DELHI, INDIA, 110005
.....Petitioner

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make the application to the Central Government (Regional Director) Under Section 13 of the Companies Act 2013, seeking confirmation of the alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of Special Resolution passed at the Extra Ordinary General Meeting held on **23 June 2026** to enable the Company to change its registered office from "NCT of Delhi" to the "State of Uttar Pradesh".

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the Company, may deliver either on MCA portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filling investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post with his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and ground of opposition to the Regional Director, Northern Region, at the address: B-2 Wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Anandya Bhawan, CGO Complex, New Delhi - 110003, within 14 Days of date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its registered office at the address mentioned below:

Address of Registered Office:H. No 4794, Gali No. 45/46 Regharpura, Karol Bagh, Central Delhi, New Delhi, Delhi, INDIA, 110005.

For and on behalf of
COLORZ N STYLE PRIVATE LIMITED
(Neeraj Jain)
Managing director
DIN:05180391
Add: B 1704, Amrapali, Platinum, Sector 119, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301

Date: 16/07/2026
PLACE: Delhi

**JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE**

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Gharota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Monu S/O Somnath R/O Satwara, Tehsil Bilaspur District Nowasher, Punjab is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 20/2007 U/S 147/323/324 RPC P/S Gharota, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/crime still absconded. It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Monu
S/O : Somnath
Address : Satwara, Tehsil Bilaspur District Nowasher, Punjab
Age : 50 years
Height : 5' 4"
Complexion : Wheatish
Eyes : Black

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail ID : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4.SP Rural Jammu : 0191-2605949
5.SDPO Akhnour : 01924-252244
6.SHO P/S Gharota : 9906285916

Sd/-
For Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu
DIP No: DIP /J-6007/26

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office : ICICI Bank Ltd, Office Number 201-B, 2nd Floor, Road No. 1 Plot No. B3, WIFI IT Park, Wagle Industrial Estate, Thane (West) - 400604.

The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA). A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Description of Secured Asset to be enforced	Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	M/s. Prem Timber & Plywood/ Mr. Mukesh Kumar alias Mr. Mukesh Daya Ram Barua/ Mrs. Reena Barua/ Mr. Dayaram Barua/ 244251000037/ 000705057808/ House No. 06, Block No. D, Sector Beta-01, Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, Greater Noida, Noida - 201308	Property 1: Plot No. 235, Survey No. 548 Paiki 1, Rajvi Residency, Moje Village Varsamed, Taluka & B/R Registration District Anjar, Registration District Kutch, State of Gujarat/ Admeasuring Plot Area 12498 Square Meter Constructed Area 149,722 Square Meter Thereon/ Bounded By:- North- Plot No. 234/ South- Plot No. 236/ East- 9.14-Meter-Wide Road/ West- Waste Land/ Property 2: Industrial Property Plot No. 02, Situated At Revenue Survey No. 510, In The Sim of Village Bhimasar, Taluka & Sub-Registration District Anjar, Registration District Kutch, State of Gujarat/ Admeasuring Plot Area 5897.47 Square Meter Constructed Area 3476.53 Square Meter Thereon/ Bounded By :- North- Revenue Survey No. 509/ South- 18 Meter Wide Road/ East- Common Plot & Revenue Survey No. 510 Paiki/ West- Industrial Plot No. 01/ Property 3: Plot No. 06, Block No. D, Sector Beta- 01 Vide Allotment No. B01-7668 Situated In Greater Noida, District Gautam Budh Nagar (UP)/ Admeasuring Area 200 Square Meter (Covered Area 77.165 Square Meter)/ Bounded By-North- 60 Meter Wide Road/ South- Plot No. 54 & 73/ East- Plot No. C7/ West- Plot No. C5	June 11, 2026 Rs. 2,70,77,969.94/-	01/05/2026

These steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower/s and/or guarantor/s (as applicable) is/are advised to make the outstanding payment within 60 days from the date of publishing this Notice. Else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: July 18, 2026
Place: Delhi Ncr & Noida

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Brahm Aman Kashyap/ Anjana Kashyap/ 002105031631	Unit/villa No.106-VL-300-38, Measuring Area 300 Sq. Yrds Approx. In The Project Called "the Villas" At Mohali Hills, Developed By M/s.emaar India Limited (Formerly Known As M/s Emaar Mgf Lands Limited), Situated At Sector-106, Mohali Hills, Sas Nagar, Mohali, Punjab, 140307. Owned By Anjana Kashyap. (admeasuring An Area Of 300.00 Sq. Yrds Approx North Plot No.106-ep-39 South: Plot No.106-ep-39 East:road 40 Feet Wide West: Plot No.106-ep-34 / Date Of Symbolic Notice 14 July, 2026	March 20,2026/ Rs. 1,12,33,068.25/-	Gurgaon/ Chandigarh/ Mohali

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: July 18, 2026 Place: Gurgaon

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**GODREJ FINANCE**

GODREJ FINANCE LIMITED

Registered office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai-400079 Maharashtra

Branch Office: Godrej Capital, R-5, Green Park (M), Near Haldiram's, New Delhi- 110016

Possession Notice (For Immovable Property)
(Rule 8(1) of The Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)
LOAN/FACILITY ACCOUNT NO.- GFL3301D0048657- LOAN AGAINST PROPERTY FLEXI FUNDS GRANTED TO MR. NITIN SHARMA AND MRS. RITU SHARMA.

Whereas, the authorized officer of the Godrej Finance Limited, a Company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 having registration as a Finance company from the Reserve Bank of India & having registered office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai-400079 Maharashtra & One of the office at Godrej Capital, R-5, Green Park (M), Near Haldiram's, New Delhi 110016 under The Securitization And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a demand Notice Dated **08.05.2026** calling upon Applicant/Borrower/Co-Applciant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors (1) Mr. Nitin Sharma and (2) Mrs. Ritu Sharma to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being **Rs. 40,64,485/- (INR Forty Lakhs Sixty-Four Thousand Four Hundred and Eighty-Five Only)** due as on **08.05.2026** with subsequent interest, penal interest, charges, costs etc. as per the agreement(s) within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The Applicant/ Borrower/ Co-Applciant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors, having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Applicant/Borrower/ Co-Applciant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors in particular and the public in general that the undersigned authorized officer of company has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on this 15th day of July 2026.

The Applicant/ Borrower/ Co-Applciant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors attention is invited to provisions of Sub- Section (8) of Section 13 of the said act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets/.

The Applicant / Borrower/ Co-Applciant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Godrej Finance Limited for the amount of **Rs. 40,64,485/- (INR Forty Lakhs Sixty-Four Thousand Four hundred and Eighty-Five Only)** due as on **08.05.2026** and interest thereon from **09.05.2026**.

Description of Secured Assets/

Property Being A Flat No. S-4, Second Floor, With Roof Rights (Rear RPS Portion), Property No. 91, Gyan Khand-1, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201014

Date: 18.07.2026
Place: Ghaziabad

Authorized Officer,
Godrej Finance Limited

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd. BP-4, Technopolis Building, 4th Floor, Sector V, Salt Lake City, Kolkata West Bengal- 700091
CIN No: L65190G11994PLC021012, www.icicibank.com

The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA). A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Description of Secured Asset to be enforced	Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Yyora Herbs Private Limited/ Binit Kumar Jha, Vikash Jha, Sangita Jha, SS Fabrication Guarantor/ Binit Kumar Jha, Yyora Herbs Private Limited Mortgagor/ Represented By Directors Binit Kumar Jha & Vikash Jha Plot No. 87 & 104, Khosra No. 149/11 & 149/1, P.H. No. 13 Tilda, Industrial Area Bortori Chhattisgarh Raipur- 493116/ 553005000035	Property 1- Plot No. 87 & 104, Part of Khosra No 149/11 & 149/1, P.H. No. 13, Bortori-Tilda Industrial Area, Village Bortori, Tehsil & District Raipur, Chhattisgarh/ Property 2- Free Hold Hig Flat No. 5, Ground Floor, Amit Co-Operative Group Housing Society Ltd, Presently Known As Amit Apartments, Category: (E) Society Flats, Colony Sr. No. 1504, Plot No. 32, Rohini Sector-13, Delhi- 110085, Admeasuring An Area On 2400 Sq Mtrs or 0.24 Hectare/ Plinth Area 96 Sq Mtrs	June 18, 2026 Rs. 1,28,86,204.4/-	04/04/2026

These steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower/s and/or guarantor/s (as applicable) is/are advised to make the outstanding payment within 60 days from the date of publishing this Notice. Else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: July 18, 2026,
Place: Delhi/ Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY**

No JBPC/NFR/E-Tender/26, Date 10/07/2026

DRM (Commercial) Jabalpur, on behalf of president of India invited E-Tender for the earning and leasing contracts from Jabalpur Division. Details are as under:- **SN: 1, Category :** Advertising - On Station Premise (NonDigital), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No :** ADVT-JBP-SGO-OSN157-26-1, **Assets Details:** 40 number of flange board each 8 sq ft (2 x 2 both side) total sq.ft = 320 sq ft. Display at COP and FOB at saugor station Special Instruction (For Asset) Prospective bidders are requested to visit the site before the E-auction for an assessment of feasibility and for adequate bidding. **Lot Start Date Time:** 21-07-26 15:00:00, **Lot End Date time:** 21-07-26 15:30:00, **SN: 2, Category :** (Advertising - On Station Premise (NonDigital), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No :** ADVT-JBP-SGO-OSN158-26-1, **Assets Details :** Contract for display of advertising through flex board at Bina Malkhedi, Khurai, Saugor, Makroniya Railway Stations. Area mentioned in the assets details., **Lot Start Date Time :** 21-07-26 15:10:00, **Lot End Date time:** 21-07-26 15:40:00, **SN: 3, Category :** (Advertising - On Station Premise (NonDigital), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No :** ADVT-JBP-PPI-OSN-156-26-1, **Assets Details :** 50 number of flange board each 8 sq ft (2 x 2 both side) total sq.ft = 400 sq ft. Display at COP and FOB at Pipariya station, **Lot Start Date Time :** 21-07-26 15:20:00, **Lot End Date time:** 21-07-26 15:50:00, **SN: 4, Category :** (Misc-Static Services Static General), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** MSS-JBP-SHRSTGen-13226-1, **Assets Details :** Creation, Operation, and Maintenance of a Food Van at Shihora Road Railway Station under Jabalpur Division for a period of Five (05) Years, **Lot Start Date Time :** 21-07-26 15:00:00, **Lot End Date time:** 21-07-26 15:30:00, **SN: 5, Category :** (Hybrid NFR-On-board Hybrid), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** HyB-OnB127872-26-1, **Assets Details :** Contract for vending of various miscellaneous items (excluding food items and Packaged Drinking Water) on board trains operating in the Satna-Rewa-Satna section over Jabalpur Division. The contract shall not be applicable to Rajdhani, Shatabdi, Vande Bharat, and any special premium trains that may be introduced in future by Railway Board. All terms and conditions shall be governed by the Scope of Work, the E-Auction Standard Conditions of Contract, and the applicable Railway policies. The mentioned rake link ID and rake number are provided only for technical compliance. The contract shall cover all trains (except Rajdhani, Shatabdi, Vande Bharat and any future special premium trains) running over the routes specified in the Special Conditions of Contract, in english, **Lot Start Date Time :** 20-07-26 15:00:00, **Lot End Date time:** 20-07-26 15:30:00, **SN: 6, Category :** (Misc-Static Services-Miscellaneous facilities at station), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** MSS-JBP-STAMedStn-123-26-1, **Assets Details :** Contract for licensing of space at Satna Railway Station for setting up, operation, and maintenance of a Medical Facilities Kiosk on as is where is basis, in accordance with applicable Railway policies., **Lot Start Date Time :** 17-07-26 15:00:00, **Lot End Date time:** 17-07-26 15:30:00, **SN: 7, Category :** (Misc-Static Services -Travel Help Desk/Travelers Information and Promotional Kiosk), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** MSS-JBP-MLMLTHDPK-73-25-1, **Assets Details :** For Cab and Tourism Promotion Desk/Kiosk at Madanmahal Railway Station under Jabalpur Division. The kiosk shall be located near the main entrance/exit of Madanmahal Railway Station, as designated by Railway authorities. The area of 100 square feet is to be allotted for kiosk purpose, **Lot Start Date Time :** 17-07-26 15:10:00, **Lot End Date time:** 17-07-26 15:40:00, **SN: 8, Category :** Misc-Static Services Static General, **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** MSS-JBP-JBPSTGen-131-26-1, **Assets Details :** Feminine kiosk at Jabalpur Station. The licensee has to obtain the necessary fire NOC and other necessary documents from the local authorities., **Lot Start Date Time:** 17-07-26 15:20:00, **Lot End Date time:** 17-07-26 15:50:00, **SN: 9, Category :** (Advertising-On Station Premise (Non Digital), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** ADVT-JBP-DMO-OSN161-26-1, **Assets Details :** Advertising through Flex Board 1100 sq.ft. at Platform, concourse, FOB, Ramp at Damoh station, **Lot Start Date Time:** 27-07-26 15:00:00, **Lot End Date time:** 27-07-26 15:30:00, **SN: 10, Category :** (Advertising-On Station Premise (Non Digital), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** ADVT-JBP-DMO-OSN159-26-1, **Assets Details :** Advertising through LED Flange at Damoh Station (area 320 sq.ft) included Cover over platform, fob, concourse, **Lot Start Date Time :** 27-07-26 15:10:00, **Lot End Date time:** 27-07-26 15:40:00, **SN: 11, Category :** Advertising-On Station Premise (Non Digital), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** ADVT-JBPJMKZ-OSN160-26-1, **Assets Details :** Advertising through LED flange (488 sq.ft.) at katni Murwara Railway Station (displat at platform, FOB, Booking Hall), **Lot Start Date Time :** 27-07-26 15:20:00, **Lot End Date time:** 27-07-26 15:50:00, **SN: 12, Category :** (Misc-Static Services Static General MSS-JBPSTGen-133-26-1, **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** MSS-JBPSTGen-133-26-1, **Assets Details :** Provision of Food van and operation at circulating area of Saugor Railway Station platform no.2 side, **Lot Start Date Time :** 23-07-26, 15:00:00, **Lot End Date time:** 23-07-26, 15:30:00, **SN: 13, Category :** (Food tray advertisement on Back of seats of trains), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** MMS-FTA127872-1-26-3, **Assets Details :** Advertisement through Vinyl Stickers on Snack/Food Trays (Seat-Back Meal Trays) in the Sitting Coaches of Train No. 11705/11706. Prospective bidders are requested to kindly visit the site /divisional office before the E-Auction regarding assets., **Lot Start Date Time :** 23-07-26, 10:00:00, **Lot End Date time:** 23-07-26 10:30:00, **SN: 14, Category :** (Food tray advertisement on Back of seats of trains), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** MMS-FTA155494-1-26-1, **Assets Details :** Advertisement through Vinyl Stickers on Snack/Food Trays (Seat-Back Meal Trays) in the Sitting Coaches of Train No. 22189/22190, 11651/11652, 11265/11266., **Lot Start Date Time :** 23-07-26, 10:10:00, **Lot End Date time:** 23-07-26, 10:40:00, **SN: 15, Category :** (Advertising -Out of Home), **Tender/E-Auction Notice No.:** ADVT-JBP-JBP-OH-102-26-1, **Assets Details:** Advertisement on over head water tank over Jabalpur Division as per assets details for the period of 05 Years, **Lot**



‘I want to play a mad character’

Kriti revealed why watching Hollywood thriller ‘Obsession’ changed her mind about safe roles

After earning acclaim for balancing commercial entertainers with content-driven films, National Award-winning actress Kriti Sanon revealed that she is now eager to challenge herself with unconventional roles. The actress admitted that she wants to move beyond familiar characters and is particularly drawn to psychologically intense parts, saying she would love to play a ‘psycho chick’ on screen.

During a conversation with ‘Humans of Bombay’, Kriti spoke about the kind of roles she hopes to explore in the future. She revealed that watching the psychological drama ‘Obsession’ inspired her to rethink her approach towards choosing scripts.

Reflecting on the impact the show had on her, Kriti said, “When I watched ‘Obsession’, I was like, ‘Oh my God, we need to stop going safe. We need to do something out of the box’. It really excited me.” She also credited stars like Zendaya for inspiring her with fearless performances and their willingness to take on emotionally demanding characters.

Expressing her desire to portray someone completely different from her real-life personality, Kriti said, “I want to play a mad character. I want to play a psycho chick. I don’t want to be safe. As an actor, it’s so exciting to live a life that’s completely different from your own and explore a person you’re



Sanon spoke about the kind of roles she hopes to explore in the future

not. I’d absolutely love to play someone completely psychotic.” According to Sanon, stepping into the mind of a psychologically complex character is one of the most exciting challenges an actor can take on.

Kriti has gradually diversified her film choices. While ‘Mimi’ won her the National Award and widespread appreciation, she continued to experiment with different genres through films like ‘Bhediya’, ‘Teri Baaton Mein Aisa Uljha Jiya’ and ‘Do Patti’.

AGENCIES

A bird’s-eye view of history

Aadhyam’s fourth play of this year is Rajat Kapoor’s latest production, ‘The Thing with Feathers’

JAI TALWAR

Aadhyam’s fourth play of this year and of Season 8 is actor, writer and director Rajat Kapoor’s latest production ‘The Thing with Feathers’, which made its debut in Mumbai on July 8 and will move to Delhi at the end of September.

Written and directed by Rajat Kapoor and co-written by Rabia Kapoor and Chandrachud Rai, the play is an original work that places human relationships at the centre of a world in transition and is set against one of the most turbulent times of the 20th century. It is not about wars, revolutions or the world they shaped. It is a tale of people who lived through it, those who continued to fall in love, built a family, grieved losses, imagined a future and began again.

Spanning the decades between 1900 and 1950 and moving across continents, the play follows ordinary lives navigating extraordinary times. Rather than looking at the events through a historical lens, the play turns its gaze towards the intimate moments that often go unnoticed.

‘The Thing with Feathers’ unfolds through the lives of those who unexpectedly cross paths, revealing how love, chance and resilience continue to shape lives in the shadow of conflict. Acting as narrators, birds are silent witnesses to both history’s grand sweep and the countless lives it never recorded.

As per Rajat Kapoor, “We started with the idea of a play based on the first half of the 20th century. A thought emerged



The play is an original work that places human relationships at the centre of a world in transition

that perhaps the story of these 50 momentous years would have an immediacy if we saw it through the lens of common folks. The play could have been many things, could have taken a thousand different forms, but eventually it became the thing that it wanted to become.”

Bringing this world to life is an accomplished ensemble cast featuring Vinay Pathak, Mantra, Neil Bhoopalam, Bhavya Rampal, Waris Ahmed Zaidi, Chandrachud Rai, Amit Purohit, Radhika Mehrotra, Vidushi Chaddha, Bhagyashree Tarke and Aaraha Mukherjee.

A MISCONCEPTION

‘3 Idiots not based on Sonam Wangchuk’

Bollywood star Aamir Khan said his character in the film ‘3 Idiots’ was not based on Sonam Wangchuk, calling it a ‘misconception’ and expressing concern over the activist’s hunger strike. Khan attended the Q&A session at the London Indian Film Festival, where he was asked by a reporter to address Wangchuk’s protest. The video has been circulating on the internet.

‘3 Idiots’ was directed by Rajkumar Hirani and released in 2009. It featured the actor in the role of Phunsukh Wangdu (Rancho). Khan said that during the making of the film, neither he nor the writers of the film knew about Wangchuk.

“No, that’s not true actually. That is a misconception. I didn’t know about Sonam Wangchuk at that time when we were doing this film ‘3 Idiots’... I want to tell you neither Raju nor Abhijat, the writers of the film, nor I. We didn’t know about Sonam. However, what he is doing is good work in any case. He doesn’t have to

Khan attended the Q&A session at the London Indian Film Festival, where he was asked by a reporter to address Wangchuk’s protest

be based on the character of ‘3 Idiots’ for us to respect him and the work that he does,” he said.

The news about Wangchuk came into the spotlight on Tuesday, after Omi Vaidya, who also featured in the film, shared the video on his ‘X’ handle, claiming Khan’s character in the film was based on the activist and urging people to draw their attention to his deteriorating health. “I know. I saw the video of Chatur (Vaidya’s character), just recently... He is wrong,” Khan added.

The actor concluded by urging

Wangchuk to stop his hunger strike. “I think all of us are very concerned for his health... We hope that it ends well. All of us are hoping he ends his fast and looks after his health,” he said.

The activist has been on an indefinite hunger strike at Delhi’s Jantar Mantar after joining the Cuckoo Janata Party’s (CJP) protest demanding education minister Dharmendra Pradhan’s resignation over alleged irregularities in the NEET examination on June 28.

According to the medical bulletin, Wangchuk has lost more than nine kg since beginning his hunger strike. His blood sugar was recorded at 80 mg/dL, pulse rate at 72 per minute, while his blood pressure was 105/61 mmHg in the lying position and 101/65 mmHg while sitting. Doctors said his hydration was fair and he remained mentally alert.

Several celebrities have expressed their concerns over Wangchuk’s condition, including Zeenat Aman, Shabana Azmi, Sonakshi Sinha and others. PTI



Rose Byrne and Jenna Ortega join ‘Nasty’



Actresses Rose Byrne and Jenna Ortega are set to feature in sports drama ‘Nasty’. The film is directed by Mary Bronstein, known for ‘Yeast’ and will be released by Warner Bros’ new indie label, ‘Clockwork’, according to the entertainment news outlet ‘Variety’.

The project reunites Byrne and Bronstein, who have previously collaborated on ‘If I Had Legs I’d Kick You’, which was released in 2025. Byrne received her first Oscar nomination in the ‘Best Actress’ category for her role in the film.

‘Nasty’ revolves around an athlete who is battling for a spot on the Olympic gymnastics team and who recognises that her greatest opponent is her coach. It is produced by Margot Robbie’s ‘LuckyChap Entertainment’ alongside Ortega.

Besides ‘Nasty’, Ortega will feature in ‘Klara and the Sun’. The film is directed by Taika Waititi and features the actor in the role of Klara. Byrne will feature in the ‘Peacock’ series ‘The Good Daughter’. Created by Karin Slaughter, the series is based on her best-selling novel. Byrne will essay the role of Samantha Quinn. PTI

Warner Bros pushes ‘The Batman Part II’ release to 2028

Warner Bros’ has delayed the release of Matt Reeves’ superhero sequel ‘The Batman Part II’ for a second time, with the Robert Pattinson-starrer now set to arrive in theatres on February 18, 2028.

The film, which was earlier scheduled to release on October 1, 2027, will now open nearly six years after the first ‘The Batman’ debuted in March 2022.

Reeves announced the new release date on Thursday by sharing the first camera test footage from the film, offering audiences their first look at Pattinson reprising his role as the Caped Crusader. The brief clip shows Pattinson in Batman’s updated suit standing in the rain before turning towards the camera.

‘The Batman Part II’ was originally slated to release in October 2025 before being postponed to October 2027 following the 2023 Hollywood writers’ and actors’



strikes. According to ‘Variety’, the latest delay will give Reeves additional time for post-production while allowing ‘Warner Bros’ to retain the film’s planned IMAX release.

Reeves has co-written the screenplay with Mattson Tomlin. Plot details remain under wraps.

Pattinson returns as Bruce Wayne alongside Jeffrey Wright as Commissioner James Gordon, Andy Serkis as Alfred Pennyworth, Colin Farrell as Oz Cobb, aka the Penguin, Jayme Lawson as Mayor Bella Real and Gil Perez-Abraham as Officer Martinez. PTI

KALKI KOECHLIN RECALLS PRODUCER TELLING HER TO GET FILLERS

‘I wanted to stab him with my fork,’ she says

Kalki Koechlin opened up about an uncomfortable experience she had with a film producer, recalling how he casually suggested she get fillers for her laugh lines during a meeting. Speaking to YouTuber and comedian Lilly Singh, Kalki said the remark left her ‘seething’, but she chose to respond with humour instead of confronting him.

Sharing the incident, Kalki recalled having lunch with a producer who was discussing his former partner, an actor. “I remember sitting with a producer and having lunch and he was talking

about his ex, who is a beautiful actress. And he was saying she did too much Botox, like she went a bit too crazy and it looked really bad.”

Kalki said the conversation then took an uncomfortable turn when the producer commented on her appearance. “And then he casually said, ‘All you need is a little filler for your laugh lines’. And I wanted to stab him with my fork. Instead, I just swallowed a piece of my food and I looked at him and I said, ‘Well, I better stop laughing so much then.’”

Although she laughed it off in that moment, Kalki admitted she was furious. “So, I remember seething from inside but trying to make a joke out of it.

But also looked at him sternly. And he stopped after that and didn’t talk about it. But it’s just those ways that people have. It’s just these subtle ways of people just slipping in comments like this.”

When Lilly Singh asked whether she beat herself up for not reacting more strongly to the producer, Kalki said she didn’t. Instead, she channelled the experience into her stage performance ‘I’m Okay’, which explores motherhood and postpartum struggles. “I included that story in the performance and it resonates a lot with women. They know exactly what I’m talking about,” she said.

Explaining why she chose not to confront the producer immediately, Kalki said not every situation allows for a direct response. “Forget about work. We have people in our family that we disagree with politically. We have to have dinner with them. We have to hear them say something that maybe we don’t agree with. And we swallow our food and we go on because you have to pick and choose the battles.”

AGENCIES



When Lilly Singh asked whether she beat herself up for not reacting more strongly to the producer, Kalki said she didn’t